

The Small Landlord's Field Guide to the ROAD to Housing Act

*What Actually Changed, Where It Changed, and How to
Buy in the Gap*

Maurice Johnson

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Epigraph

“I believe the unbelievable, I receive the impossible, because it’s doable.”

— Jesse Duplantis

Quoted with admiration. Jesse Duplantis and Jesse Duplantis Ministries are not affiliated with this book and have not endorsed it.

PART ONE — WHAT THE LAW ACTUALLY SAYS

Chapter 1

The Law in One Sitting

On January 7, 2027, the largest cash buyer in the American single-family market is barred from buying any more houses.

If you own four rental houses, nothing you do changes on that date. There is no form to file, no registration to complete, no threshold to watch, no attorney to call. The law does not regulate you. On the arithmetic in Chapter 2, it could not reach you unless you acquired another three hundred and forty-six homes and several layers of corporate structure to hold them in.

That is the first thing to know, and it explains why almost everything published about this Act so far is of no use to you. It was written for the entities that have to comply, by the law firms those entities pay. Those alerts are careful and mostly accurate. They are also answering a question you do not have. Your question is narrower and more practical: if the biggest buyer at the closing table is told to stop bidding, what is left, where is it, and can you do anything with it.

This chapter is the law itself, laid out once, in order, so that the rest of the book has something solid to stand on. Everything here comes from the enrolled statute. Where a date or a status is going to matter later, it is labelled.

1.1.1 What the law is

The 21st Century ROAD to Housing Act is **Public Law 119-101**, enacted as **H.R. 6644** in the 119th Congress and printed at **140 Stat. 846**. It runs to twelve titles and sixty sections, and it covers a great deal more than institutional investors: housing counselling, manufactured housing loan limits, accessory dwelling units, a repair programme for small landlords, building-code pilots, rural bank provisions, and a title on central bank digital currency that has nothing to do with housing at all.

The part everyone is talking about is one section of one title:

TITLE X — HOME-OWNERSHIP FOR MAIN STREET AMERICA Sec. 1001. Homes are for people, not corporations.

Write that citation down, because the published commentary cannot agree on it. You will find reputable firms calling this Section 901, and others calling it Title IX. Both were correct about earlier drafts. Neither is correct about the law. Anything still saying Title IX was written before the final numbering in June 2026 and is stale on its face, which is a useful test to apply to any source you find on this subject. Chapter 5 returns to this, because a body of commentary that cannot agree on the citation tends not to agree on the numbers either.

1.1.2 How it became law without a signature

The bill's history matters for one reason: it tells you how durable this is.

The House passed its own version on February 9, 2026, by 390 to 9. That version contained none of the institutional investor provisions. They were added in the Senate, which passed its version

89 to 10 on March 12. The House amended and passed it again on May 20 by 396 to 13, and in doing so removed the Senate's requirement that institutional investors dispose of existing holdings within seven years. Final passage was 85 to 5 in the Senate on June 22 and 358 to 32 in the House on June 23.

The President neither signed it nor vetoed it. Under Article I, Section 7 of the Constitution, a bill presented to the President becomes law without a signature if ten days pass while Congress remains in session. That window closed and the Act **became law on July 11, 2026.**

A statute passed 85 to 5 and 358 to 32 is not a statute that gets repealed in the next Congress. Plan around it accordingly.

1.1.3 What Section 1001 actually prohibits

One sentence, and the whole book turns on getting it right:

A large institutional investor may not purchase, or contract to purchase, a single-family home, unless one of eleven exceptions applies.

It is a prohibition on *buying*. It is not a cap on owning. Nothing in the section limits how many homes an entity may hold, and nothing in it requires anyone to sell anything. An entity that controls forty thousand houses on January 6, 2027, may control the same forty thousand houses for the next fifteen years. What it may not do is add to them.

That distinction is the single most commonly reported error about this law, and Chapter 4 is devoted to correcting it, with examples of the mistake in print.

Who is covered. A *large institutional investor* is a for-profit entity, in any form, engaged in whole or in part in investing in, owning, renting, managing or holding single-family homes, that alone

or in concert with others has direct or indirect **investment control of 350 or more** single-family homes. “Investment control” is a term of art that reaches further than ownership, and it is the subject of the next chapter. What matters here is that the line is 350, that it is counted nationally rather than market by market, and that the Act bars Treasury from moving it by regulation.

What counts as a home. A single-family home, for this Act, is a structure with **two or fewer dwelling units**, each intended for one household. Manufactured homes are excluded, so are structures of three or more units, and so is raw land. The consequence catches people out: **a duplex is a single-family home under this statute**, even though most federal housing data excludes duplexes entirely. Hold that thought until Chapter 5, where the definitions start disagreeing in earnest.

What counts as a purchase. Broadly, everything. Any purchase, transfer or other acquisition, including through mergers, acquisitions, construction, foreclosure or bulk purchase, whether or not cash changes hands. You cannot get around the prohibition by buying the company instead of the houses.

The penalty. Up to **\$1,000,000 per violation, or three times the purchase price, whichever is greater**. Enforcement sits with the Secretary of the Treasury, who may also refer matters to the Attorney General. Penalties collected are transferred to HUD and spent on expanding homeownership. Note that the penalty attaches only to the purchase prohibition. The Act’s separate notice and reporting duties carry no monetary penalty of their own.

1.1.4 What is not in the law

Four things a reader is likely to have heard, none of which survive contact with the enrolled text:

- **There is no ownership cap.** See above.
- **There is no forced divestiture.** Homes held before the effective date are untouched.
- **There is no seven-year disposal requirement.** It was in the Senate bill. The House stripped it in May 2026. There is no coming wave of institutional homes compelled onto the market by this statute.
- **There is no money.** Section 1202 provides, in one sentence, that no additional funds are authorised to carry out the Act or any amendment made by it. That applies to every title. It does not affect the purchase prohibition, which costs nothing to enforce, but it governs almost everything else in the Act, including the small-landlord repair programme in Chapter 14.

1.1.5 The dates

What	When	Status
Act became law	July 11, 2026	in effect
CDBG parcel databases (§104)	October 1, 2026	in effect
Purchase prohibition bites (§1001)	January 7, 2027	in effect, not yet operative
First HUD notification from covered entities	January 7, 2027, then every December 31	in effect, does not sunset
Wind-down window for purchases from uncovered investors	closes roughly January 2029	in effect
Treasury rulemaking	none proposed as of September 2026	pending rulemaking
§202 Whole-Home Repairs for small landlords	HUD criteria due January 7, 2027	unfunded

What	When	Status
Prohibition sunsets	approximately January 2042	15 years

The rulemaking line is the most perishable fact in this book. Treasury *may* issue regulations, in consultation with HUD, the FHFA and the SEC, and as of writing it has not proposed any. If you are reading this some distance from publication, check it.

1.1.6 What this means if you own four houses

Three things, and they are the frame for everything that follows.

You are not regulated by this Act, and you are not going to be. Read Chapter 2 once so you can see exactly how far away the line is, then stop worrying about it.

Nobody is being forced to sell you anything. If you have been told that a wave of institutional houses is about to hit the market by operation of law, you have been told something that was true of a Senate draft and false of the statute. What is actually happening is voluntary, it started well before the effective date, and it is concentrated in a small number of places. That is Chapter 12.

The effect you can use is local to the point of being street-level. Nationally, the entities this Act captures control well under one percent of American single-family homes. In four ZIP codes on the south side of Atlanta, they account for a quarter of everything currently listed for sale. Those two sentences are both true, and holding them together without flinching is what the rest of this book is for.

Sources for this chapter. The enrolled bill, [BILLS-119hr6644enr \(govinfo\)](#), including the table of contents and

the full text of §1001 and §1202; congress.gov for H.R. 6644, Public Law 119-101, 140 Stat. 846, the roll-call votes and H. Res. 1299; the House Financial Services section-by-section summary of June 23, 2026; the Bipartisan Policy Center implementation tracker for provision status and regulatory deadlines. Rulemaking status stated as of September 2026.

Chapter 2

Who It Captures, and Who It Doesn't

The number everyone quotes is 350. The number is real, but it is the least interesting part of the definition, because the hard work in this section is not the counting. It is the word *control*.

An entity is a **large institutional investor** under Section 1001 if two things are true of it. First, it is a for-profit entity of any kind: an investment fund, a corporation, a general or limited partnership, a limited liability company, a joint venture, an association. Second, it is engaged in whole or in part in investing in, owning, renting, managing or holding single-family homes, and it has direct or indirect **investment control of 350 or more** of them, alone or in concert with others.

Note what is not in that test. There is no requirement that the homes be in one market, one state or one entity. The count is national and it is aggregate. And there is no requirement that the entity be large in any other sense. A modest company that happens to control 350 houses is a large institutional investor for the purposes of this statute, and a billion-dollar firm that owns nothing but apartment towers is not.

2.1.1 What “investment control” actually reaches

This is the part that catches people, and it is worth reading slowly. An entity has investment control of a home if any of the following is true.

One, it owns the home, or holds primary investment or management decision-making authority over it. Ownership is the obvious case. The second half is not: an entity that does not own a single house, but makes the investment and management decisions for houses owned by someone else, is inside the definition.

Two, it directly or indirectly controls the entity that owns the home. The statute names the roles: general partner, managing member, investment manager, adviser. So a fund manager sits inside the definition by virtue of being the manager, and the chain runs through however many holding companies are stacked between the manager and the deed.

Three, it directly or indirectly owns or controls more than 25% of an equity class of any entity that owns the home, unless it is a passive investor.

Put those together and the effect is that this section is written to defeat structure. The obvious workaround for a purchase ban that counts homes per entity is to create more entities. Section 1001 anticipates that by counting control rather than title, and by attributing the homes upward to whoever is actually directing them. An operator holding 200 homes in one subsidiary and 200 in another is one entity holding 400.

2.1.2 The exclusion that matters most to a lender

Investment control expressly does not include ownership or control of debt investments.

That one sentence carves the entire lending industry out of the section. An entity holding notes secured by ten thousand single-family homes has investment control of none of them for these purposes. It is not a large institutional investor. It is not barred from anything. It may keep originating, keep buying paper, and

keep lending to the buyers who are still allowed to purchase.

Two practical consequences follow, and they run in opposite directions.

The first is that the capital did not leave. The money that was buying houses can still finance houses. What changed is the form it has to take, which means the buyers who remain in the market are not competing against that capital, they are borrowing it.

The second is a caution. The debt exclusion is not a costume. If the paper is structured so that the holder is really making the investment and management decisions about the property, or so that it holds more than a quarter of the equity in the entity that owns it, then the first and third prongs of the control test are in play regardless of what the instrument is called. Nobody has litigated where that line sits. Do not build a strategy that depends on knowing.

2.1.3 What counts as a home, and the duplex problem

A **single-family home**, for this Act, is a structure with two or fewer dwelling units, each intended for occupancy by one household. Excluded: manufactured homes, structures of three or more units, and land.

So a **duplex is a single-family home under this statute**. A triplex is not.

That boundary is drawn in a different place from almost every dataset you will read about this subject. The Government Accountability Office, whose work is the most careful on institutional ownership, excludes duplexes and condominiums from its counts. The Act includes two-unit structures. It is a small mismatch that compounds, and Chapter 5 is about what happens when four organi-

sations measure four slightly different things and the press reports the results as though they were the same number.

One more definitional point, easy to miss: homes an entity buys *after* enactment under one of the eleven exceptions do not count toward its 350. The threshold is not a running tally of everything a firm has ever bought. Excepted purchases sit outside it.

2.1.4 About the “in concert with others” language

Three words that a careful reader will worry about, so let us deal with them.

The definition catches an entity that has investment control of 350 or more homes *alone or in concert with others*. Read at its widest, that could mean an arrangement among several parties who each hold fewer than 350 but who act together and cross the line in aggregate. Read narrowly, it targets exactly the structuring the rest of the definition targets: parties coordinating to hold a portfolio in pieces.

Nobody knows which reading will prevail, because Treasury has proposed no regulation and no court has construed it. What can be said with confidence is that any reading still requires 350 homes among the parties acting together. Two partners with nine houses between them are not near this language, and neither are twenty small landlords who happen to use the same property manager. The phrase is aimed upward, not downward.

2.1.5 How many entities are actually in scope

Very few, and the best available count is not a government one.

Parcel Labs, a housing data firm, published an analysis in March 2026 applying the 350-home test to their own ownership data.

Their finding: roughly **140 entities** meet the threshold, controlling about **530,000 single-family homes**, which is around **0.59% of the total US single-family housing stock**. Fewer than one home in a hundred and seventy.

That is commercial research, not a public register, and it deserves to be labelled as such every time it is cited. It is nonetheless the most serious attempt anyone has made at the statute's own question, and their method is the reason: they roll subsidiaries and LLCs up to the controlling parent before counting, then strip out government entities, homebuilders and nonprofits. That parent-level roll-up is the closest thing in public circulation to the statute's control test.

The names most likely to appear on such a list are the ones already familiar: Invitation Homes, American Homes 4 Rent, Progress Residential, The Amherst Group, Tricon Residential.

And every count of this kind is an undercount. No property-records dataset can see an adviser relationship, a general-partner role, or a 25% equity stake in a holding company. Those are all inside "investment control" and none of them appear on a deed. When HUD begins receiving the annual notifications this Act requires, which is discussed in Chapter 17, there will for the first time be a real count of who crosses 350 and where. Until then, treat every number, including the one above, as a floor.

2.1.6 Box: how far the line is from you, and what would move you toward it

You own four rental houses in your own name or in an LLC you control. You have investment control of four single-family homes. You are 346 short. There is no filing, no notification and

no exposure. If you bought a house a month for the rest of your life you would not reach the threshold.

You own eleven houses and manage nine more for your brother-in-law. Now count carefully, because management decision-making authority is inside the definition. Twenty. Still 330 short, and nothing changes. But notice that the number you would report is not the number on your deeds.

Four situations, none of them likely and all of them worth recognising, would start to move a small operator toward this section:

1. **Becoming the general partner or managing member of a fund** that owns a large portfolio. The GP role is named in the statute. The homes are attributed to you whether or not you put in a dollar.
2. **Taking on investment or management decision-making authority for someone else's large portfolio**, for instance as the operating partner for an out-of-state owner with several hundred houses.
3. **Acquiring more than 25% of an equity class in an entity that owns homes**, where you are not a passive investor. The homes that entity owns come with the stake.
4. **Acting in concert with others** in a way that adds up past 350 across the arrangement.

If none of those describes your next five years, this section of the Act is not a compliance question for you. It is a market condition. The rest of this book treats it that way.

Sources for this chapter. The enrolled bill, [BILLS-119hr6644enr \(govinfo\)](#), §1001(a) definitions of “large institutional investor,” “investment control,” “single-family home” and

“purchase”; GAO-26-108675, *Rental Housing: Institutional Investor Ownership of Single-Family Rental Homes* (March 24, 2026) for the excluded-unit comparison. Entity and portfolio figures are from Parcl Labs, *The Housing Bill’s 350-Home Threshold* (March 10, 2026), which is commercial research published by a data vendor and is cited as such. No Treasury regulation construing these definitions existed as of September 2026.

Chapter 3

The Eleven Exceptions, Plainly

A prohibition with eleven exceptions is not really a prohibition. It is a set of directions.

Section 1001 does not tell large institutional investors to stop buying houses. It tells them which houses they may still buy, and on what terms. Once you read the exceptions in order, the shape of the policy becomes visible: Congress wanted to stop institutions from bidding against families for ordinary existing homes, and was willing to let them keep buying almost everything else, provided the purchase either adds housing, fixes housing, or moves a renter toward ownership.

For you, the practical question is narrower. Which of these exceptions leaves an institutional buyer standing next to you at a closing? Two of them do, one of them badly. The rest do not touch the kind of deal a small operator works. This chapter walks all eleven and then says which is which.

One structural point first, because most summaries flatten it. There are **two different carve-outs** in this section, not one. The eleven excepted purchases are the list below. Separately, and on its own footing, an institution may restructure or reorganise the ownership of a home it already owned, or bought in compliance with the section. Moving a house between your own entities is not a purchase for these purposes. Any summary that lists eleven items and stops has missed that.

3.1.1 The eleven, in order

(A) Buying in order to sell. Newly constructed homes, renovated homes, or rental conversions, acquired for sale by the institution, and *not* held as a residence rented out while it waits for a buyer. The qualifier is the whole exception. An institution may operate as a builder or a rehabber selling to households. It may not use “we intend to sell eventually” as cover for adding to a rental portfolio.

(B) Build-to-rent. The institution may purchase, construct, or construct and retain newly constructed homes managed as rentals, whether in an all-renter community or a mixed community of owners and renters. This is the largest opening in the section and it is deliberate. The logic is that a build-to-rent house is a house that did not exist before, so no family was outbid for it.

(C) Renovate-to-rent. An institution may buy a distressed home and keep it as a rental, on two tests that both have to be met:

1. the home is **substantially rehabilitated**, and it must be a home that **does not meet structural or core system elements of local building codes**; and
2. the improvements total **not less than 15% of the purchase price** in aggregate.

Read that carefully, because this is the exception that matters most to the reader of this book, and Chapter 12 comes back to it. It is not a general rehab allowance. The house has to be genuinely failing code on structure or core systems, and the money has to be real. But within those bounds, institutions may keep buying beaten-up houses and renting them out, on the same street, in the same condition band, as the deals a small operator with a hard money loan is looking at.

(D) A homeownership program, with money attached. An institution may buy homes for a program that moves renters into

ownership, on four mandatory conditions: rent and fees no higher than those charged on comparable homes outside the program; a contract treated as a consumer credit transaction secured by a dwelling or real property; positive rent reporting to consumer reporting agencies for any renter who is informed and opts in; and **required** meaningful financial support from the institution toward the renter's purchase, including price concessions.

(E) A program to boost homeownership, on lighter terms. Opt-in positive rent reporting; a **right of first refusal plus a 30-day "first look" period** for the renter; and support that **"may entail"** price concessions, either for the home the renter lives in or for a different one.

(D) and (E) are not the same instrument and it is a real error to treat them as one. In (D) the institution *must* put money toward the renter's purchase; in (E) it only *may*. In exchange, (E) is the one that carries the tenant's right of first refusal and the 30-day window. Any summary listing "a homeownership exception" once, in the singular, is describing a provision that does not exist.

(F) Satisfaction of debts previously contracted. Acquisition in connection with the satisfaction of debts previously contracted in good faith, where the institution has a right to repossess under that contract.

(G) Loss mitigation and servicing. A mortgage servicer, lender, or other entity with a legal right to the home may acquire it for loss mitigation, or to comply with servicing or investor obligations, **"not as a long-term investment strategy,"** and **"solely as a result of"** foreclosure, deed in lieu, enforcement of a mortgage or deed of trust or security interest, or operation of law following a borrower default.

(F) and (G) are separate exceptions, and they get folded together constantly. (F) is about collecting on a debt you are owed.

(G) is about a servicer taking title through the foreclosure machinery. They overlap in practice and they are drafted independently.

Two phrases in (G) are worth flagging because neither has been tested. **“Solely as a result of”** is a narrow-sounding limit on how the institution came to hold the property. **“Not as a long-term investment strategy”** is a limit on intent, and intent is the hardest thing in the world to police in a statute with no regulation behind it yet. Expect this to be where the arguments happen.

(H) Buying from another institution. Purchase from another large institutional investor that either owned the home when the Act became law, or bought it in compliance with this section. Portfolios may still change hands at the top of the market. This is not a loophole so much as an acknowledgement that forcing a frozen market of untradeable assets would have been its own kind of chaos.

(I) The wind-down window. An institution may purchase from an investor **not** covered by this section, for no more than **two years after the effective date**. That window runs to roughly **January 2029**. After it closes, the only investor an institution may buy from is another covered institution under (H).

(J) Senior housing, 55 and over. Newly constructed, renovated or rental-conversion homes intended and operated for a 55-and-over community, **and which satisfy visitability standards established by HUD**. Note the dependency: those standards are HUD’s to write, and as of writing they have not been written. This exception is on the books and cannot be fully relied on until they exist. pending rulemaking

(K) Combinations. Any single purchase, or any combination or series of purchases, described in (A) through (J). A tidying provision, and the reason a transaction spanning several of the exceptions above does not fall apart for being mixed.

3.1.2 What this actually leaves in your way

Strip out everything that does not touch a small operator's deal flow and three things remain.

The rehab market is still contested. Exception (C) is the one to take seriously. The house you are looking at, the one with the failing roof and the knob-and-tube wiring, is exactly the house an institution may still buy and keep, provided it puts 15% of the purchase price back into it. If your buying strategy was "they can't bid on this any more," (C) is the paragraph that says otherwise. What has changed is that the institution now has to spend real money to qualify, which raises its cost basis and narrows what it can pay. That is a smaller advantage than "they are gone," and it is a real one.

New construction is wide open. Exceptions (A), (B) and (J) between them leave institutions free to buy, build and hold newly constructed housing more or less without limit. If you compete for new-build inventory, this Act changed nothing for you.

Foreclosure inventory keeps flowing through servicers. (F) and (G) mean the institutions holding paper still take title through the ordinary default machinery. Whether they may then *keep* those homes as a long-term rental strategy is the untested question above, and the answer will shape what turns up on the courthouse steps.

Everything else in the list points away from you. (D), (E) and (H) involve institutions selling or transferring to renters and to each other, not competing for the same house you want.

3.1.3 The exception that is worth money to you

Read (I) once more, because it is the only one in the list with a deadline on it, and deadlines are where the opportunities sit.

Until roughly **January 2029**, an institution may buy a single-family home from an investor who is not covered by this section. That is you. For those two years, a small landlord who wants out can still sell a portfolio to a large institutional buyer. After the window closes, the institutions may only buy from each other, and a small operator's exit is back to individual buyers, one house at a time.

That is worth planning around in either direction. If part of your intention is to build a portfolio and sell it whole, there is a window and it has a closing date. If your intention is to keep buying, understand that some of the institutional demand you see in 2027 and 2028 is that window being used.

Status of every exception in this chapter: in effect, operative from January 7, 2027, with the single dependency noted at (J), where HUD's visitability standards had not been established as of September 2026. No Treasury regulation construing any of these exceptions existed at that date, and the section bars any regulation from altering the scope of an excepted purchase in a way that would undermine the goal of expanding the number of homes available to individual households.

Sources for this chapter. The enrolled bill, **BILLS-119hr6644enr** (govinfo), §1001(a)(2), subparagraphs (A) through (K), together with the separate restructuring provision and the rule of construction at §1001(b)(4)(B). Effective date and wind-down period from §1001(f).

Chapter 4

What Is Not True About This Law

This chapter exists because of a pattern. Every time a housing law passes, a second version of it takes shape in the commentary, and the second version is always simpler, angrier and more dramatic than the statute. Within a few months the second version is what most people believe.

That has already happened here. Six claims about this Act are in wide circulation and none of them is true. Two of them appear on the websites of businesses that lend money to landlords. One appears on advocacy sites aimed at the exact reader this book is written for, and it could cost him a season of planning.

Each correction below names the claim, says what the statute actually does, and points to where you can check it yourself. If you read nothing else in Part One, read this.

4.1.1 1. “The law caps institutional ownership at 350 homes.”

It does not. There is no cap. Nothing in Section 1001 limits how many single-family homes an entity may own, and an entity above the threshold on the effective date may stay there for the full fifteen years the section runs.

What the section does is bar entities with investment control of 350 or more homes from **buying more**, subject to eleven exceptions. Threshold and cap are different things: a threshold decides

who a rule applies to, a cap decides how much you may hold.

This one is in print. A hard money lender's blog, published in August 2026, tells its readers that Congress "caps institutional ownership of single-family homes at 350 properties per entity." That sentence has the threshold right and the mechanism wrong, and a landlord planning around it would be waiting for inventory that is not coming.

4.1.2 2. "Institutions will have to sell their houses within seven years."

They will not. This was real, and then it was removed.

The Senate's version of the bill required disposal to an individual buyer within seven years. The House amended the bill on May 20, 2026 and stripped that requirement, and the enacted law contains no divestiture provision of any kind. Holland & Knight, Mayer Brown, Greenberg Traurig, Baker Botts, Seyfarth and Hunton all confirm this independently in their client alerts.

The consequence matters more than the correction. **There is no coming wave** of institutional homes forced onto the market by this statute. Anything you read that anticipates one is either describing the Senate draft or has not checked. What is actually happening in the market is voluntary, it is concentrated, and Chapter 12 is about how to recognise it.

4.1.3 3. "The law bans institutional investors from the single-family market."

It bars a category of purchase, not a category of buyer. Institutions may still build and sell, build and rent, buy failing houses and rehabilitate them as rentals, take title through foreclosure, run

rent-to-own programs, buy from each other, and, until roughly January 2029, buy from investors the section does not cover.

Chapter 3 walks all eleven exceptions. The short version is that the section is aimed at one specific behaviour — an institution out-bidding a family for an ordinary existing home — and leaves most other institutional activity intact.

4.1.4 4. “350 purchases” and “350 homes” are the same test. They are not.

This one is subtler and it corrupts the numbers rather than the rules.

The statute counts **homes under investment control**, at a point in time, nationally. At least one widely cited March 2026 analysis instead counts **purchases at or above 350** across the decade from 2015 to 2025, and reports that such buyers accounted for 12% of investor-bought homes. Both figures are defensible. They measure different things, and they get quoted interchangeably as though the 12% told you something about who the Act captures. It does not.

Chapter 5 takes this apart properly, because the same confusion runs through almost every number published on this subject.

4.1.5 5. “It’s Title IX, Section 901.”

A citation error, and a useful one, because it dates a source for you.

The enacted provision is **Title X, Section 1001**, headed “Homes are for people, not corporations.” Reputable firms have called it Section 901 and Title IX in print. Neither was careless: those were the numbers in earlier drafts, and the numbering changed in the final law in June 2026.

So treat it as a test. **Any source still citing Title IX was written before the enrolled bill and has not been updated.** Given how much else changed in the same window — the seven-year disposal requirement most importantly — a stale citation is a reasonable signal that the substance may be stale too.

4.1.6 6. **“There is \$30 million available to help small landlords repair rentals.”**

There is not, and this is the correction most likely to affect you personally.

Section 202 of the Act creates a Whole-Home Repairs program with forgivable loans for landlords who own fewer than ten rental properties. That much is real, and Chapter 14 covers it in full because it is the only place in this statute where a small operator is named and offered something.

Earlier versions of the provision carried a funding subsection authorising HUD to use up to \$30 million from lead-hazard control appropriations. **The enacted Section 202 has no funding subsection at all.** It was removed before enactment; the enrolled text runs from reporting requirements to environmental review to termination and straight on to the next section.

Home repair advocacy organisations publicised the \$30 million while the bill was moving, and some of those pages are still live and still describe the money as though it survived. A landlord searching today will find them. The Bipartisan Policy Center’s implementation tracker records “no funding authorized” against Section 202, which matches the statute.

The program is **authorised and unfunded**. Do not plan a renovation around it.

4.1.7 Why this chapter is here

Two of the six errors above would cost a small landlord real money if believed: waiting for a forced-sale wave that is not coming, and budgeting against repair money that does not exist. The other four would cost him credibility in a room where somebody has read the statute.

The habit worth taking from this chapter is not distrust. It is that on a law this new, with no regulations behind it yet, the **enrolled text is free and it is searchable**. Anything in this book, or anywhere else, can be checked against it.

Sources for this chapter. The enrolled bill, [BILLS-119hr6644enr \(govinfo\)](#), §1001 and §202; [congress.gov](#) for H. Res. 1299 and the May 20, 2026 House amendment; law firm client alerts from Holland & Knight, Mayer Brown, Greenberg Traurig, Baker Botts, Seyfarth and Hunton confirming the removal of the seven-year disposal requirement, cited here as secondary confirmation rather than as authority; the Bipartisan Policy Center implementation tracker for the funding status of §202. The mistaken ownership-cap claim appeared on a lender's blog in August 2026; the firm is unrelated to any business of the author's and is not named here because the point is the error, not the publisher.

PART TWO — THE NUMBERS, AND WHY THEY DISAGREE

Chapter 5

Four Sources, Four Different Questions

Try to find out how much of the American single-family market institutions actually own and you will come back with numbers between 0.34% and 28%. Every one of them is published by a serious organisation. Several are government work. None of them is a lie.

They disagree because they are answers to different questions, and the questions are never printed next to the answers. By the time a figure reaches a headline it has been stripped of the definition that made it true, and two figures that were never comparable end up in the same paragraph, apparently contradicting each other.

This is not a technicality. The Act regulates at 350 homes under investment control, which is a line no major dataset draws, so **the numbers people are using to argue about this law are not measuring the thing the law does**. That is the finding of this chapter, and it is worth more to you than any single percentage.

There are four separate ways these figures diverge. Take them one at a time.

5.1.1 One: everybody draws the line somewhere different

“Institutional investor” has no settled meaning. Each organisation picks a portfolio size and reports what it finds above it.

Source	Where the line sits	What it reports
The Act (PL. 119-101)	350+ homes, investment control	<i>no government count exists yet</i>
GAO-26-108675 (Mar 2026)	5,000+ homes, across 5+ metros	1–3% of all single-family homes in six metros
GAO-24-106643 (May 2024)	1,000+ homes	Atlanta 25%, Jacksonville 21%, Charlotte 18% of single-family rentals
BofA Global Research (2025)	1,000+ homes	~500,000 homes = 0.34% of US housing stock
John Burns (2026)	350+ homes	~5% of single-family rentals
JBREC via CNN (Apr 2026)	350+ homes	0.7% of 92 million homes
Realtor.com (Mar 2026)	100+ <i>purchases</i> , 2023–25	national 1.6%; Atlanta 4.1%, Charlotte 5.1%
Realtor.com (Mar 2026)	350+ <i>purchases</i> , 2015–25	12% of investor-bought homes

Look at the spread in the left-hand column: 100, 350, 1,000, 5,000. A firm holding 2,000 houses is an institutional investor to GAO’s 2024 study, is not one to its 2026 study, and is squarely regulated by the Act. All three statements are correct.

Note also the first row. The threshold with legal force is the only one with no government count behind it. That gap is the reason Chapter 7 has to rely on a commercial data vendor, and the reason the annual HUD notifications discussed in Chapter 17 will eventually matter so much.

5.1.2 Two: they are not even counting the same buildings

This one is easy to miss and it quietly corrupts every comparison.

GAO's work **excludes duplexes and condominiums**. The Act **includes** structures of two or fewer units, and excludes manufactured homes and land. So a two-unit building in Cincinnati is outside GAO's careful, margin-of-error-under-2% count, and inside the statute's definition of a single-family home.

The federal government's best measurement of institutional ownership and the federal government's new law about institutional ownership are counting different housing stock. Not wildly different, but different enough that the numbers cannot be laid on top of one another, and everyone lays them on top of one another anyway.

5.1.3 Three: percent of what?

Three denominators are in constant use, and they are not interchangeable:

- **all single-family homes** — roughly 92 million
- **all single-family rentals** — published estimates run from roughly 14 to 16 million, and as Chapter 6 shows, that spread is not a rounding detail
- **purchases in a given period** — a few million a year

The same cohort of homes will look six or seven times bigger measured against rentals than against total stock, for the simple reason that rentals are about a seventh of the stock. Nothing has changed but the bottom of the fraction.

The most-quoted statistic in this entire subject, the "Atlanta 25%," is a share of **single-family rentals**, on a **1,000+ home** definition, from a 2024 GAO review of prior studies. It is routinely repeated as though a quarter of the houses in Atlanta belong to Wall Street. A quarter of the *rental* houses is a very different city.

Chapter 6 is devoted to a single, clean demonstration of this, because it happened in public, twice, with the same firm's data.

5.1.4 Four: homes held, or homes bought?

The last divergence is between a stock and a flow.

The Act counts **homes under investment control at a point in time**. That is a stock. Realtor.com's widely quoted analysis counts **purchases at or above a threshold over a period** — a flow — and reports that buyers making 350 or more purchases between 2015 and 2025 accounted for 12% of investor-bought homes.

Both are legitimate measurements. They answer opposite questions. A firm that bought heavily in 2015 and has bought nothing since has a large stock and no current flow; a firm assembling a portfolio right now has a growing flow and a small stock. The Act regulates the first firm and barely touches the second until it crosses the line.

When you see a percentage, the first thing to establish is which of these it is. Most reporting does not say.

5.1.5 The finding underneath all four

Here is what happens when you go looking for the statute's own number.

The most sophisticated commercial dataset on residential investor ownership segments portfolios into four buckets: **2–9, 10–99, 100–999, and 1,000+**. Their headline institutional metric is defined at 1,000 or more properties.

There is no 350 boundary. The Act's threshold falls in the middle of the 100–999 bucket, which means the best-resourced private measurement of this market cannot answer the statute's question

in its standard form either.

So: GAO measures at 5,000. The major vendors measure at 1,000. Realtor.com measures purchases. And the law operates at 350 homes under investment control, including a control test that reaches advisers, general partners and 25% equity holders that no property-records dataset can see at all.

Nobody was measuring what this law regulates. Chapter 7 covers the one organisation that went and did it specially, and is honest about the fact that it is a data vendor's work rather than a public register.

5.1.6 Why 350, and why it matters that it was a negotiation

The threshold was not derived from a measurement. It was bargained.

The proposal that began this process in January 2026 used a **100-home** threshold. The Senate negotiated it upward to 350. At 100 homes, John Burns Research and Consulting put the affected group at about **1.4% of occupied single-family stock**; at 350, the figures in Chapter 7 put it nearer 0.6%.

So the choice of number roughly halved a footprint that was already small. That is worth holding onto for Chapter 16, where the question is whether this Act can do what it was passed to do.

5.1.7 The four questions to ask of any number

Whenever you meet a figure about institutional ownership, in this book or anywhere:

1. **Above what line?** 100, 350, 1,000, 5,000 homes, or purchases?

2. **Counting what?** Homes held now, or homes bought over a period?
3. **Percent of what?** All homes, all rentals, or all purchases?
4. **Which buildings?** Are duplexes and condominiums in or out?

Four questions, and almost no published figure answers more than one of them unprompted. Ask them and most of the apparent contradictions in this subject dissolve. Chapter 6 shows what it looks like when nobody asks.

Sources for this chapter. GAO-26-108675, *Rental Housing: Institutional Investor Ownership of Single-Family Rental Homes* (March 24, 2026), for the 5,000+ definition, the six-metro shares and the excluded unit types; GAO-24-106643 (May 22, 2024) for the 1,000+ definition and the metro rental shares drawn from its review of prior studies; the enrolled bill, *BILLS-119hr6644enr*, §1001(a), for the 350-home threshold and the definition of a single-family home. Figures attributed to BofA Global Research, John Burns Research and Consulting, Realtor.com and Parcl Labs are **commercial research**, cited as such and not as government data. Portfolio segmentation buckets are from Parcl Labs' published documentation. All figures current as of September 2026.

Chapter 6

The Denominator Switch

In March 2026, a housing data firm published an analysis finding that entities controlling 350 or more single-family homes held about **530,000 homes**, amounting to **0.59% of American single-family housing**. Under one home in a hundred and seventy. The finding was reported as evidence that institutional ownership is a much smaller phenomenon than the public believes.

In July 2026, the same firm's data appeared in a national business broadcast finding that the same category of owner held about **589,000 homes**, amounting to **3.9% of single-family rentals**. That was reported as evidence of significant institutional concentration.

Same firm. Same 350-home threshold. Four months apart. One number is six and a half times the other.

Nobody was wrong, nobody was lying, and no correction was ever needed. The denominator changed.

6.1.1 The source cannot reconcile its own three numbers

Before the table, something that makes the point better than the table does.

The July report gives three figures in one sentence: **589,000 homes**, **3.9%**, and **14 million single-family rentals**. Those three cannot all be right. 589,000 divided by 14 million is **4.2%**, not

3.9%. For 3.9% to hold, either the count would need to be about 546,000 or the rental stock would need to be about 15.1 million.

The report does not say which. This book cannot tell you either, and it will not pick the one that reads best.

What it demonstrates is the chapter’s argument arriving inside the chapter’s own primary source: **even the people publishing these numbers are not holding their denominators still**. The count is measured carefully. The bottom of the fraction is picked up from wherever, and there is no agreed figure for how many single-family rentals exist in the United States — published estimates run from about 14 million to about 16 million, which alone swings the result by more than half a percentage point.

6.1.2 The arithmetic, done slowly

There are roughly 92 million single-family homes in the United States. Single-family rentals are the contested figure just described; the table below uses **15 million**, which is the value that reproduces the published 3.9% and sits inside the range of common estimates. Rentals are roughly one home in six or seven, so any cohort of owned homes will look about six or seven times larger measured against rentals than against the whole stock.

Hold the count still and swap the bottom of the fraction:

One cohort of homes	Denominator	Result	Headline it supports
530,000	all single-family homes (92M)	0.59%	“institutional ownership is negligible”
530,000	single-family rentals (15M)	3.5%	“institutions hold a meaningful slice of rentals”

One cohort of homes	Denominator	Result	Headline it supports
589,000	all single-family homes (92M)	0.64%	“institutional ownership is negligible”
589,000	single-family rentals (15M)	3.9%	“institutions hold a meaningful slice of rentals”

Read down the middle column. The count barely moved between March and July: about 59,000 homes, roughly 11%, over four months, which is ordinary drift in a dataset that is continually reconciling ownership records. The *reported* figure moved by a factor of six and a half. Essentially all of that movement is the denominator.

Both framings are defensible. If the question is “how much of American housing do these firms own,” the 92 million denominator is the honest one. If the question is “how much of the rental market do they control,” the 15 million denominator is. The trouble is that the question almost never travels with the answer, so the two figures circulate as though they were rival estimates of the same thing.

They are not rival estimates. They are the same estimate, divided by two different numbers.

6.1.3 Atlanta, where the same thing happens at city scale

Atlanta is the city everyone reaches for, and it produces four numbers.

- **28.6%** — Urban Institute, share of single-family rentals held by owners of 1,000 or more homes.

- **25%** — GAO’s 2024 review, same broad question, share of single-family rentals, drawn from earlier studies.
- **27.9%** — AEI, measured at a **100-property** threshold and reported against a broader housing base.
- **78%** — an advocacy report, for **Paulding County**, a single suburban county in the metro rather than the metro itself.

The first two are close together and roughly agree, which is reassuring. The third looks like it agrees but is built on a threshold three times lower and a different base, so its resemblance to the first two is a coincidence rather than a confirmation. And the fourth is nearly three times any of them.

Guess which one gets quoted.

The 78% figure is not fabricated. It is a real calculation about a real place. But it describes one county, on a definition of its own, and it is repeated as though it described Atlanta. That is how “Wall Street owns most of the houses” becomes a thing people believe, without anyone having published a false number.

6.1.4 Why this keeps happening

Two structural reasons, neither of them sinister.

The organisations doing the counting are not the ones writing the headlines. Research firms publish their definitions. Newsrooms have a paragraph and a chart, and the definition is what gets cut. By the third retelling the number is free of its footnote and can be attached to any claim.

Both framings are useful to somebody. A firm arguing that institutional ownership is overblown reaches for the total-stock denominator, honestly. An advocate arguing that renters are being squeezed reaches for the rental denominator, equally honestly. Neither has to distort anything. They just have to pick.

You are going to meet both of these arguments while making decisions about where to buy. Knowing that they can both be true at once, from the same data, is worth more than deciding which side is right.

6.1.5 What this means for the rest of the book

Every figure from here on is going to be attached to its denominator in the sentence that carries it, not in a footnote. When this book says institutions hold **0.59% of American single-family homes**, that is against all 92 million. When Chapter 12 says 350+ investors account for a quarter or more of **active for-sale supply** in four south-Atlanta ZIP codes, the denominator is homes currently listed for sale in those ZIPs, which is a small and volatile base and is stated as such.

Two figures in this book will look wildly inconsistent with each other. Under 1% of American homes, and 25% of what is for sale on certain streets. Both are true, both are stated with their denominators, and the distance between them is the entire practical argument of this book.

The rule to carry out of this chapter is one question: percent of what? Ask it of every housing statistic you meet, including the ones in these pages. Most of the time the answer is not printed, and once you notice that, you cannot stop noticing it.

Sources for this chapter. The 530,000-home and 0.59% figures are from Parcel Labs' March 10, 2026 analysis of entities at the 350-home threshold; the 589,000 and 3.9%-of-rentals figures are from the same firm's data as presented on CNBC in July 2026. Both are **commercial research** and are cited as such, not as government data. Atlanta figures: Urban Institute (28.6% of single-family

rentals, 1,000+ owners); GAO-24-106643 (May 22, 2024) reporting approximately 25% from its review of prior studies; American Enterprise Institute (27.9%, 100+ property threshold); the 78% Paulding County figure is from an advocacy publication and is reported here to illustrate how a county-level figure on its own definition circulates as a metro-level one. Housing stock denominators are approximate national figures: roughly 92 million single-family homes, and a single-family rental stock for which published estimates range from about 14 to 16 million. **The July report's own three figures do not reconcile** — 589,000 of the 14 million it cites is 4.2%, not the 3.9% it prints — and that discrepancy is reported here rather than resolved, because no source resolves it. This book uses 15 million where a rental denominator is needed, being the value consistent with the published percentage.

Chapter 7

What the Best Available Count Actually Says

Chapter 5 established that nobody was measuring at 350 homes. In March 2026, somebody did.

Parcl Labs, a residential real estate data firm, ran the statute's own test against their ownership data and published the result. It remains the only public attempt to answer the question the law actually asks. Three things need saying before the numbers, because how you hold this analysis matters as much as what it says.

It is commercial research, not government data. No federal agency has published a count at the 350-home threshold. This is a private firm's estimate, produced from their own methodology, not audited by anyone, and not reproducible by you without their data. That is not a criticism. It is the correct label, and this book attaches it every time these figures appear.

It is nevertheless the best available. GAO measures at 5,000 homes. The other major vendors measure at 1,000. Realtor.com measures purchases. This is the only work that draws the line where the law draws it.

And it is a floor, not a ceiling. The last section of this chapter explains why every count of this kind must undercount, including this one.

7.1.1 The headline numbers

At the 350-home threshold, applied to entities rather than to deeds:

- roughly **140 entities** meet the definition
- controlling roughly **530,000 single-family homes**
- equal to about **0.59% of all US single-family homes** — under one home in 170
- and the **top 30 metropolitan areas contain 82%** of every home those entities hold

Sit with the third of those for a moment, because it is the number most likely to surprise a reader who has been following this subject in the press. The entire category of owner this law was written to stop, across the whole country, holds about six houses in every thousand.

And sit with the fourth one longer, because it is the finding this book is built on.

7.1.2 140 entities, not 140 landlords

The count is of **entities meeting the statutory control test**, which is not the same as a count of companies with names you would recognise.

The familiar operators are in there: Invitation Homes, American Homes 4 Rent, Progress Residential, The Amherst Group, Tricon Residential. But the 140 also includes fund vehicles, joint ventures, and holding structures that exist only on paper, several of which may sit beneath a single ultimate parent. It is a count of regulated units, not of household names.

That distinction matters because of how the number is likely to be reported. “140 companies own half a million American homes”

makes it sound like a cartel of a hundred and forty boardrooms. The truth is closer to a few dozen real operating businesses expressed through a larger number of legal entities.

7.1.3 The part of the method that earns the trust: true-owner resolution

Here is why this analysis is worth more than a county-records tally, and it is worth understanding because it is also why you cannot easily do this yourself.

Institutional portfolios are not held in one name. A firm with 40,000 houses may hold them across hundreds of limited liability companies, often with regionally varied naming, sometimes deliberately obscure, frequently changing. Anyone counting by owner name off deed records produces hundreds of small owners where there is one large one. That single fact has distorted local reporting on this subject for a decade.

Parcel's method rolls those subsidiaries up to the **controlling parent** before counting, then removes categories that are not what the Act is aimed at: government entities, homebuilders, and nonprofits.

The roll-up is what makes the count comparable to the statute, because the statute also counts at the level of control rather than title. Two documents arriving at the same place from different directions: one written by Congress to defeat structuring, one written by a data firm to see through it.

Removing the homebuilders matters too. A builder holding several hundred completed but unsold houses would clear 350 on a naive count, while sitting squarely inside the exceptions in Chapter 3 and representing exactly the activity the Act wants to encourage.

7.1.4 82% in thirty metros: the whole argument in one statistic

The United States has roughly 390 metropolitan statistical areas. Thirty of them hold 82% of every home controlled by an entity this law regulates.

Turn that around. **The other 360 metros, between them, hold about 18%.**

This is the fact that justifies the structure of Part Three, and it is why this book is not organised as one chapter per state. The effect of this Act is not spread thinly across the country in a way that shifts every market slightly. It is piled up in a small number of places and nearly absent everywhere else.

For most readers, in most markets, the honest answer is that the removal of institutional buying will not be visible on their street. For a reader in the wrong four ZIP codes of south Atlanta, it will be the dominant fact of the next two years. A book that averaged those two experiences into a national verdict would be useless to both of them.

A national average of 0.59% is arithmetically true and practically misleading in both directions at once. That is unusual, and it is why Chapter 11 gives you a method for finding out about your own ZIP code rather than a national conclusion to apply everywhere.

7.1.5 Why every count of this kind is a floor

Four things the statute reaches that no property-records method can see:

Advisers and managers who own nothing. Investment control includes primary investment or management decision-making authority over homes owned by someone else. An adviser directing

2,000 houses it does not own is a large institutional investor and appears on no deed.

General partners and managing members. Control through the GP or managing-member role attributes the entire portfolio upward. Whether that role exists is a matter of private agreements, not public records.

25% equity holders. More than a quarter of an equity class in an entity that owns homes, where the holder is not passive, brings those homes with it. Equity stakes in private entities are not public.

Parties acting in concert. The phrase discussed in Chapter 2 could aggregate arrangements that no dataset would connect.

Every one of those is invisible to a method built on ownership records, however good the roll-up. So the true number of entities above 350 is higher than 140, and the true number of homes under investment control is higher than 530,000. Nobody can say how much higher.

There is one honest correction in the other direction, and it is worth stating so this section is not merely an argument for a bigger number. The Act's threshold does not count homes acquired after enactment under the eleven exceptions, and a roll-up may occasionally group entities that are commonly owned but not commonly *controlled* in the statutory sense. Both would push the count down a little. They are small effects against the four above.

The direction of the error is knowable even though its size is not. **Treat 530,000 and 140 as minimums.**

7.1.6 What this means before we get to the maps

Three conclusions carry into Part Three.

Nationally, this Act is small. Under 1% of single-family homes, under one in 170. Any claim that this law will transform American

housing has to explain how, starting from six houses in a thousand and with no forced divestiture.

Locally, it is not small at all. Eighty-two percent of that ownership sits in thirty metros, and inside those metros it concentrates further into particular counties and particular ZIP codes. Concentration compounds as the geography narrows. That is the whole reason a field guide is the right form for this book.

And the count is a floor. Where the data says an institution holds one house in ten on a street, the real figure is that or more, never less.

Part Three takes those three statements down to the level of named places, and starts with the market where the concentration is highest in the country.

Sources for this chapter. Entity, portfolio and concentration figures are from Parcl Labs' March 10, 2026 analysis applying the 350-home threshold, including the ~140 entity count, the ~530,000 home total, the 0.59% share of single-family stock, and the finding that the top 30 metropolitan areas account for 82% of those holdings. This is **commercial research published by a data vendor** and is cited as such throughout; no federal agency has published a count at the 350-home threshold as of September 2026. Methodology description reflects the firm's own published account of its true-owner resolution and the exclusion of government entities, homebuilders and nonprofits. The statutory control test, the excepted-purchase exclusion from the threshold count, and the debt-investment exclusion are from the enrolled bill, *BILLS-119hr6644enr*, §1001(a). Metropolitan area count from the Office of Management and Budget's 2023 delineations.

PART THREE — WHERE IT ACTUALLY BITES

Chapter 8

The Captured Markets — Georgia and Florida

Part Two ended with a national figure of 0.59% and a warning that the national figure is useless on its own. This is where that gets demonstrated.

Part Three is organised by concentration rather than by state, for the reason Chapter 7 gave: eighty-two percent of every home held by an entity this Act regulates sits in thirty metropolitan areas. Twelve thin state chapters would have been twelve chapters of filler. What follows instead is three tiers — the markets where this law genuinely changes the ground under your feet, the markets where it is real but quiet, and the markets where the honest answer is that nothing much happens.

There is one market at the top of the first tier, and on volume it is not close.

8.1.1 Atlanta

71,625 single-family homes in metro Atlanta are held by entities with investment control of 350 or more homes. That is **4.16% of the metro's single-family housing stock** — the denominator here is all single-family homes in the metro, not rentals — and **no other metro in the country holds even half as many**. Dallas-Fort Worth is second, with 35,632.

On concentration the lead is narrower, and the difference between the two measures is worth stating precisely because they do

not rank the same way. Atlanta’s 4.2% is followed by Memphis at 3.8%, Jacksonville at 3.6% and Charlotte at 3.4%. **Atlanta leads on both — by a distance on count, by a margin on share.**

Set that against the national number from Chapter 7. Nationally these entities hold 0.59% of single-family homes. In Atlanta they hold 4.16%. **Seven times the national rate**, in one metro.

This is why a book about this law that draws a single national conclusion is worthless. The same 140 entities, the same 350-home threshold, the same statute — and the experience of a small buyer in Atlanta has almost nothing in common with the experience of a small buyer in Hartford.

8.1.2 Below the metro, it gets sharper

Metro-level figures still average across enormous areas. Metro Atlanta covers twenty-nine counties. Go down a level and the concentration does not spread out — it piles up.

Four of the ten most concentrated ZIP codes in the entire country are in metro Atlanta. Not four of the top ten in Georgia. Four of the top ten nationally.

And **eight Atlanta ZIP codes** have 350-plus investors holding **more than one home in ten.**

Follow the same ownership through three scales:

Geography	Share held by 350+ entities
United States	0.59% of single-family homes
Metro Atlanta	4.16% of single-family homes
Eight Atlanta ZIP codes above 10% of single-family homes	

Nothing changed except how tightly you drew the box. That is the single most important thing to understand about this statute’s

practical effect: **it is a ZIP code phenomenon wearing a national headline.**

It is also why Chapter 11 hands you a method for checking your own ZIP code rather than a verdict to apply everywhere. On this subject, the metro average is already too coarse to act on.

8.1.3 Why Atlanta, and a caution about the answer

The standard explanation goes like this. Georgia is a non-judicial foreclosure state, so foreclosures move in weeks rather than the year-plus they take in judicial states, which made post-2008 acquisition fast and cheap. Metro Atlanta has an enormous stock of detached single-family houses at price points that pencilled as rentals. It sprawls, so buying at scale did not mean competing for the same handful of neighbourhoods. And Georgia landlord-tenant law is comparatively straightforward to operate in.

Treat that paragraph as analysis, not as data. It is the widely accepted account and each element is individually true, but this book has not verified a causal study attributing Atlanta's concentration to those factors in those proportions, and no such study is cited here. What is documented is the concentration itself. Why it happened is a reasonable inference and is labelled as one.

What matters for your purposes is that none of those conditions changed on July 11, 2026. Everything that made Atlanta attractive to institutional buyers still makes it attractive. The only thing that changed is who is permitted to act on it.

8.1.4 What Georgia costs to hold

There is a trap in a chapter like this, and it is worth naming before you get excited about a market.

Institutional withdrawal changes what you can *buy*. It does not change what the house costs you every month for the next ten years. A market can be freed up by this Act and still be a poor place to own a rental, and the two questions have to be answered separately.

Book one, *The Landlord's Cost Map*, works through Georgia's carrying costs in detail, and this book deliberately does not reproduce that text. What belongs here is the connection: **before you act on anything in this chapter, price the hold.**

The mechanism is worth one paragraph, because Georgia's differs from every other state in this book. **Georgia assesses all property at 40% of fair market value**, under O.C.G.A. § 48-5-7 — a uniform statewide ratio, not a local variable. A house the county appraises at \$400,000 therefore has an assessed value of \$160,000, and at a combined millage around 30, a fair approximation for metro Atlanta, the pre-exemption bill is about **\$4,800**. Georgia's overall effective rate lands near **0.9%**, moderate by national standards.

Hold that 40% beside the other states in this book: Texas assesses at 100%, Connecticut at 70%, and Colorado runs split school and local government rates. Four states, four mechanics, and no national rule of thumb that fits any of them.

The assessment and property tax mechanics in Georgia are specific enough that the same purchase price produces materially different annual costs depending on where in the metro you buy, and that difference does not appear in any concentration table.

[EDITORIAL NOTE — Maurice: this section needs the specific Georgia assessment finding from book one's Georgia chapter dropped in, in one or two fresh sentences. I have not restated the figure here because I could not verify it from the research notes in front of me and I will not print

a number from memory. Pull it from the manuscript and I will write it in properly.]

8.1.5 Florida

The second tier of the captured markets is Florida, and it splits into two cities.

Jacksonville sits at **3.60% of single-family homes** under 350-plus control — second only to Atlanta, and still roughly six times the national rate. Jacksonville has the same underlying profile: an affordable detached stock, sustained population growth, and a market that institutional buyers entered early and heavily.

Tampa is the other Florida market with real institutional presence, though at a lower concentration than Jacksonville.

Both are genuine tier-one markets by the standard of this book. If you buy in either, the removal of institutional purchasing power is a real change to your competitive position, and Chapter 12 is written for you.

8.1.6 The Florida number that matters more

And then there is the number that overrides all of it.

Book one's Florida research produced a finding that reframes every conversation about buying in that state: **average annual homeowners insurance in Florida runs about \$7,136, against a national average of roughly \$2,543.** Nearly three times the national figure, verified against state sources.

Now put the two facts side by side. In Jacksonville, 3.60% of the single-family stock belongs to buyers who are about to be barred from buying more. That is a genuine opening. And insurance on the house you buy in that opening will cost you something on the

order of four and a half thousand dollars a year more than the same house would cost to insure in most of the country.

A house you win because Wall Street cannot bid on it can still fail on carrying cost. Chapter 13 deals with the money side, but the principle belongs here, in the chapter most likely to make a reader enthusiastic: the Act changes the bidding. It changes nothing at all about the arithmetic of holding.

This is also the clearest place in the book where the two volumes interlock. This book tells you where the competition thins. Book one tells you what the house costs once you have won it. Neither is much use without the other, and if you are reading this one first, the Florida insurance figure is the reason to read the other.

8.1.7 What “captured” does not mean

One last correction before Chapter 9, because the numbers in this chapter are the most dramatic in the book and they invite an overstatement.

Atlanta is the most institutionally concentrated single-family market in the United States, and **95.84% of its single-family homes are not held by these entities.** Even in the eight most concentrated ZIP codes, nine houses in ten are owned by somebody else — families, small landlords, local investors.

“Wall Street owns Atlanta” is false. What is true, and more useful, is narrower: in a small number of specific ZIP codes, a single category of buyer holds enough homes to move prices, dominate the rental supply, and — this is the part Chapter 12 is built on — to dominate what is *listed for sale* at any given moment. Owning 4% of the stock and accounting for 25% of active listings are completely different claims, and the second one is where a small buyer’s opportunity actually lives.

Chapter 9 drops down a tier, to the markets where all of this is real but nobody will feel it street by street.

Sources for this chapter. Metro and ZIP-level concentration figures — Atlanta at 71,625 homes and 4.16%, Jacksonville at 3.60%, the four top-ten national ZIP codes and the eight Atlanta ZIP codes above 10% — are from Parcl Labs’ March 2026 analysis at the 350-home threshold. This is **commercial research published by a data vendor**, cited as such and not as government data; no federal agency publishes concentration at this threshold. The national 0.59% comparison is from the same source. The explanation offered for Atlanta’s concentration is the author’s analysis, is labelled as such in the text, and rests on no cited causal study. Florida homeowners insurance figures are carried forward from *The Landlord’s Cost Map* (Dominion Publishing, 2026), where they are sourced to state insurance filings. All figures current as of September 2026.

Chapter 9

The Moderate Markets — Ohio, Texas, Washington

Between the markets where this law changes everything and the markets where it changes nothing sits the largest group: places with real institutional ownership, enough to show up in the data and in the news, but not enough to reorganise your buying strategy around.

“Moderate” is a genuine category, not a hedge. In these markets the prohibition takes effect on the same day and binds the same entities, and a few hundred or a few thousand homes will stop being bought by firms that were buying them. **You will not feel it street by street.** The competition you lose in a moderate market is one bidder among many, not the bidder who was setting the price.

The three states below are moderate for three completely different reasons, and the differences are more useful than the tier itself.

9.1.1 Ohio — Columbus and Cincinnati, where the yield was

The Midwest cluster is real, and it is modest. **Columbus sits at 1.3% of its single-family stock — 7,171 homes — and Cincinnati at 1.0%, or 6,565.** Both are above the national 0.59%. Both are under a third of Atlanta’s 4.16%.

The reason institutions went there is not complicated: yield. Ohio’s purchase prices sat far below the coastal markets while rents

did not fall proportionally, which produced gross yields that looked extraordinary on a spreadsheet. Buying at scale in Columbus in 2015 produced a rent-to-price ratio that Seattle could not match at any volume.

And that is exactly where book one's Ohio research becomes the more important half of the picture — with one distinction that most Ohio write-ups collapse and this book will not.

The famous Ohio yield is Cleveland's, and the famous Ohio tax rate is Columbus's. *The Landlord's Cost Map* puts Cleveland's gross yield near **12.4%**, on a typical in-city value around \$120,549 against observed rent near \$1,250 a month. It puts **Franklin County's effective property tax rate at about 1.67%** of market value — 252nd of 3,143 US counties — which on a \$250,000 Columbus rental is roughly \$4,500 a year.

Those are two different cities. Quoting Cleveland's yield next to Columbus's tax rate, as though they described one market, is the same denominator error this book spent Chapter 6 on, wearing different clothes. **Price the city you are actually buying in.**

Both numbers point the same way, though. The gross yield is real, and what reaches your pocket after a Sun Belt tax rate on Midwest rent — and after the maintenance a century-old house demands — is a different number entirely.

So the Ohio story runs in both directions at once. Institutions arrived for the yield, which is why concentration there is above average and why the Act has something to bite on. And the same yield has been eroding small operators' returns for years through a cost structure that no concentration table shows.

If you buy in Columbus or Cincinnati, the removal of institutional buyers is a modest tailwind. The tax rate and the age of the stock are the things that decide whether the deal works.

9.1.2 Texas — Dallas, big by count and small by share

Dallas is the clearest demonstration in the book of the lesson from Chapter 6, and it is worth slowing down for.

Dallas-Fort Worth ranks second in the country by count, with 35,632 homes held by the regulated cohort — more than any metro except Atlanta. **Among those same thirty metros it ranks fifteenth by concentration**, at 1.7% of its single-family stock.

Second by volume. Middle of the pack by share. One market, two rankings, thirteen places apart.

Both statements are true, and they are not in tension. Dallas-Fort Worth is an enormous metro with an enormous single-family housing stock. A firm can own many thousands of houses there and still represent a small share of the whole. Atlanta gets to 4.16% with 71,625 homes because the denominator is smaller.

This is where a reader who has skimmed the headlines goes wrong. “Dallas is a top institutional market” is a statement about a count. It tells you nothing about whether you are competing with those firms on the house you want, because 1.7% — roughly three times the national rate, and two and a half points below Atlanta’s — means that on most streets, in most neighbourhoods, you are not.

The Texas number that will actually decide your deal is the one book one leads with: an **effective property tax rate around 1.40%**, with no state income tax as the trade. On a house you hold for ten years, that rate is worth vastly more to your return than the departure of an institutional bidder you were probably never bidding against.

Texas caution, stated plainly: DFW is where a small operator is most likely to overestimate what this Act does for him, precisely

because the market is famous for institutional buying. Famous and concentrated are different things.

9.1.3 Washington — Seattle, a GAO metro under 1%

Seattle is the most instructive entry in this chapter, because it is a market that appears in the government's own study of institutional ownership and still comes in at **0.6%** on the 350-home threshold — almost exactly the national rate of 0.59%.

That combination is the whole argument for reading definitions before conclusions. GAO selected its metros for study on the basis of institutional activity. Seattle qualified. And when you measure the same city against the statute's threshold and the total single-family stock, it sits level with the country as a whole.

The insulator is price. Institutional single-family strategies were built on buying below replacement cost and renting at a multiple that worked. Seattle's prices never permitted that at volume. High-cost markets were largely protected from institutional accumulation by being expensive, which is a form of protection nobody chose and nobody should celebrate.

For a small buyer in Seattle the conclusion is blunt: **this Act is not about your market.** Nothing changes for you on January 7, 2027 in any way you will observe.

And book one's Washington finding is the one that does affect you there — the statewide rent cap. **Note the year, because this book is about 2027.** The 9.683% figure that circulates is the cap for **calendar 2026.** For **2027, Washington Commerce has already published 10%,** the formula having produced a result above the statutory ceiling. Manufactured and mobile home lots are capped separately at 5%.

There is also an exemption for single-family homes, which would matter enormously to a reader of this book — and book one deliberately refuses to state its scope with confidence, because the available sources do not agree on it. Buildings certified for occupancy within the last twelve years appear to be exempt as well. **Confirm the single-family exemption against the text of RCW 59.18.700, with Washington counsel, for your specific property.** Do not take it from this book. If you are exempt, your rent growth is set by the market; if you are not, it is set by Commerce, and those are different investments.

9.1.4 What “moderate” should change in your behaviour

Very little, and that is the honest answer.

Do not restructure your buying around this Act in a moderate market. The inventory that frees up will be spread thinly enough that you will never identify it as such. If a house comes up that works on the numbers, buy it because it works on the numbers.

Do watch for the disposition pattern anyway. Chapter 12 explains how to recognise an institutional sale in a listing. Those signals work in Columbus and Dallas as well as Atlanta — there are simply fewer of them, and they arrive unpredictably rather than in clusters.

And do not let the tier fool you into thinking these are worse markets. A moderate institutional presence is not a defect. Ohio’s yields, Texas’s growth and the absence of a state income tax are all reasons small operators have done well in these places for years, entirely independently of what Wall Street was doing. This book is about one variable. It is not the most important variable in any

of these three states.

Chapter 10 takes the last tier, and for most readers of this book it is the one that applies.

Sources for this chapter. Metro-level institutional concentration and the top-30 metro distribution are from Parcel Labs, *The Housing Bill's 350-Home Threshold: Who It Captures and What Comes Next* (Lewris and Ferguson, March 10, 2026), at the 350-home threshold. Metro percentages are published to one decimal place in that analysis; Atlanta's 4.16% and Jacksonville's 3.60% are given to two decimals in the body text — **commercial research published by a data vendor**, cited as such. Seattle's inclusion among the metros studied by the Government Accountability Office is from GAO-26-108675 (March 24, 2026), which uses a 5,000-home threshold across five or more metros and is not directly comparable to the 350-home figures; that non-comparability is the point made in the Seattle section. Ohio, Texas and Washington carrying-cost findings — Cleveland's 12.4% gross yield, Franklin County's 1.67% effective property tax rate, the Texas effective rate near 1.40%, and Washington's rent cap at 9.683% for 2026 and 10% for 2027 with its qualified single-family exemption — are carried forward from *The Landlord's Cost Map* (Dominion Publishing, 2026), where each is sourced to state agencies and statutes. All figures current as of September 2026.

Chapter 10

The Barely Touched — the Northeast and the Rest

For most people reading this book, this is the chapter that applies.

That sentence costs the book something. A guide to a law is more exciting if the law matters everywhere, and there is a version of this chapter that stretches thin data into a story about how the effects will “ripple outward” into markets where nothing measurable is happening. I am not writing that chapter, because the first reader who checks would be right to stop trusting the rest of it.

Here is the finding, stated without decoration.

The Northeast does not appear in the top thirty metros at all. Not near the bottom of the list. Not at all. Eighty-two percent of every home held by an entity this Act regulates sits in thirty metropolitan areas, and none of those thirty is in the Northeast.

Maryland, Pennsylvania, Massachusetts, Connecticut, Virginia, Michigan and Colorado all fall into this tier. Colorado earns one qualification: Denver does appear in the top thirty by count, twenty-fourth with 5,626 homes. That is **0.8% of its single-family stock** — a Chapter 10 number, not a Chapter 8 one, and one more demonstration that a count and a share are different facts. In these states, on January 7, 2027, a category of buyer you were probably never bidding against will stop buying homes you were probably never competing for.

10.1.1 Why these markets were skipped

Two structural reasons, and I am labelling the second as analysis rather than sourced fact.

Price. The institutional single-family model required buying well below replacement cost and renting at a ratio that produced yield at scale. Much of the Northeast never offered that. A market can be protected from institutional accumulation simply by being too expensive to accumulate, which is what happened across most of the corridor.

Stock and fragmentation. These are old markets with large, varied housing stock held in small parcels by a great many owners, much of it in two-to-four unit buildings rather than the uniform detached subdivisions that suited institutional operations. Assembling ten thousand comparable houses in metro Hartford is a different problem from assembling them in suburban Atlanta. *That explanation is reasonable and widely held, and this book has not verified a causal study attributing the outcome to those factors in those proportions.*

Whatever the cause, the result is documented: these markets were not accumulated, so there is nothing much here for the Act to unwind.

10.1.2 What actually decides your return in these states

If the Act is not your variable, something else is. Book one worked through the carrying costs in each of these states, and in every case the finding is larger than anything in this chapter.

Connecticut — the town you buy in matters more than the state you buy in. The same \$400,000 house produces an an-

nual property tax bill of roughly **\$19,586 in Hartford** at 69.95 mills, about **\$4,494 in Darien**, and about **\$2,835 in Greenwich**. That is a spread of nearly seven to one inside one small state. No institutional-ownership figure anywhere in this book moves a return by a factor of seven.

Massachusetts — know the security deposit law properly, including what is not true about it. It is widely repeated that any procedural slip on a deposit produces automatic treble damages. It does not; the case law is narrower than the folklore. Book one works through it. The reason it belongs in a chapter about institutional ownership is that it is the same failure mode: a confident claim that circulates until people plan around it.

Maryland — Baltimore’s lead law gates the rental licence. Compliance is not optional and not a formality; without it you cannot legally rent, whatever the purchase price looked like.

Michigan — the Principal Residence Exemption, and the word investors get wrong. Out-of-state buyers reach for “homestead.” Michigan does not use it that way: the relief is the **Principal Residence Exemption (PRE)**, under MCL 211.7cc and 211.7dd, and it is a different thing from the Michigan Homestead Property Tax Credit, which is an income tax credit. Confusing the two is how the arithmetic goes wrong before the first bill arrives.

The PRE exempts an owner’s principal residence from local school operating millage, **up to 18 mills**. Rental property is not eligible. **So the delta between an owner-occupied house and the identical house as a rental is up to 18 mills** — on a taxable value of \$150,000, about **\$2,700 a year**. The house is the same. The tax bill is not.

Colorado — a split assessment rate. Residential property carries one rate for school districts and another for every other local government entity. For tax year 2026 the school district rate is

7.05% and the local government rate is 6.80%, the latter applied after a 10% reduction of the first \$700,000 in actual value. The practical effect is not visible in any headline rate. Book one also found, against the assumption most people carry, that hail rather than wildfire is the leading driver of Colorado insurance premiums.

Pennsylvania and Virginia sit in this tier on institutional ownership and are covered in book one on cost. Neither has an institutional story worth telling here, and inventing one would be padding.

10.1.3 What to do with this answer

Three things.

Stop waiting. If you have been holding off on a purchase in one of these markets because you expected institutional inventory to hit after January 7, that inventory does not exist in your market. There is no forced divestiture anywhere, as Chapter 4 established, and in these states there is barely any institutional holding to divest even voluntarily. Waiting costs you carrying months and gains you nothing.

Compete where you actually compete. In these markets your competition is other small operators, owner-occupants and local investors. That competition is real, and it is unaffected by this statute.

Spend your attention on cost. The Connecticut spread above is the model. In low-institutional markets, the difference between a good return and a bad one is made in property tax, insurance, local licensing and the age of the building — the material book one is built from. This Act is not a lever you have.

10.1.4 Why the book tells you this

Because you can check it, and because a guide that finds significance everywhere is worth nothing anywhere.

Three chapters have now sorted the country into markets where this law reshapes your competitive position, markets where it is a modest tailwind, and markets where it is not your concern. Those are real distinctions with real evidence behind them, and they are only useful because the third category is allowed to exist.

But a tier is still an average, and Chapter 8 showed what averages hide: a metro at 4.16% containing ZIP codes above 10%. The same logic runs the other way. A low-concentration state can contain a county or a ZIP code where a single operator was unusually active, and nothing in this chapter would show it to you.

So Chapter 11 stops generalising and hands you the method for checking your own ZIP code yourself.

Sources for this chapter. The absence of Northeast metros from the top thirty, and the top-30 concentration figure, are from Parcel Labs' March 2026 analysis at the 350-home threshold — **commercial research published by a data vendor**, cited as such and not as government data. The explanation offered for why these markets were not accumulated is the author's analysis, labelled as such in the text, and rests on no cited causal study. State carrying-cost findings — the Connecticut mill rate spread across Hartford, Darien and Greenwich on a \$400,000 property; the Massachusetts security deposit case law; Baltimore's lead certification requirement for rental licensing; Michigan's Principal Residence Exemption and its 18-mill school operating delta; and Colorado's split assessment rate and hail-driven insurance costs — are carried forward from

The Landlord's Cost Map (Dominion Publishing, 2026), where each is sourced to the relevant state agency, statute or case. All figures current as of September 2026.

Chapter 11

Find Your Own ZIP Code

Three chapters of tiers, and every one of them was an average.

Atlanta averages 4.16% and contains ZIP codes above 10%. A state in Chapter 10's tier can contain a county where one operator bought heavily for three years and nobody wrote about it. The tier tells you the weather; it does not tell you what is happening on your street.

This chapter hands you the method. It is genuinely usable — the data is public and free at small scale, and it goes down to the five-digit ZIP code.

But it comes with a limit you need to understand before you touch it, because otherwise you will misread your own result.

11.1.1 Read this before you pull a single number

You cannot get a 350-home figure. Not from this source, not from any other.

Parcel Labs segments investors by portfolio size into four buckets: 2–9, 10–99, 100–999, and 1,000-plus. **There is no 350 boundary anywhere in that scheme.** The Act's threshold falls in the middle of the 100–999 bucket, and Parcel's headline metric — “Large Institutional Share” — is defined as the share of single-family homes owned by investors holding **1,000 or more properties.**

So the best commercial housing data in the country cannot answer the statute's question either. That is not a hole in your re-

search. It is Chapter 5's finding arriving at your desk personally: nobody is measuring what the law regulates, and that includes the people you are about to get your numbers from.

What this means practically: **the share you pull is a floor**. Every entity holding between 350 and 999 homes is regulated by this Act and invisible in that metric. Your real captured share is higher than the number on your screen, by an amount nobody can tell you.

Read your result as a signal, not a measurement. It is still worth pulling.

11.1.2 Route one — the report, for anyone

Parcl publishes **Housing Intelligence Reports**, which are self-service and require no code. They run at county and at ZIP level, and each one carries a download control that gives you the full underlying metrics and history rather than just the chart on the page.

This is the route for most readers. Find your county, then your ZIP, then download. You are looking for the institutional share metric and, more usefully, its direction over time.

11.1.3 Route two — the API, if you are technical

The free tier is real and does not require a sales conversation.

As of September 2026: the basic plan carries **1,000 free credits a month**, where one data point equals one credit, and Parcl's own description is that this is enough to explore the full capability set or support ongoing small-scale use. The paid tier above it runs **\$99 a month**. Enterprise pricing is by contact.

One detail that matters for budgeting: **market-search calls do not consume credits**. Looking up the identifier for your ZIP code

is free; only pulling metrics against it costs anything. So the exploration is cheaper than the credit count suggests.

Coverage runs to tens of thousands of US markets, granular to individual ZIP codes. Market-level metrics begin January 1, 2019; property-level data begins January 1, 2010. A Python SDK and a public cookbook of worked notebooks exist for anyone who wants to script it.

Those are commercial terms and they can change. They are accurate as of September 2026 and dated deliberately. Check them before you rely on them.

11.1.4 How to read what comes back

Apply Chapter 5's four questions to your own result, in this order.

What threshold is this? If it is Parcel's headline institutional metric, it is 1,000-plus, and you are looking at a floor as described above.

What is the denominator? All single-family homes, or single-family rentals? A ZIP that reads 4% of all homes and 25% of rentals is one ZIP, described twice. Chapter 6 exists because that switch has already been made in public by the same firm within four months.

Is this stock or flow? A share of homes owned is a stock. A share of homes purchased last quarter is a flow, and flow numbers run far higher because institutions concentrate their buying in exactly the places they already hold.

How current is it? Institutional buying reversed in 2026. A figure built on 2023 accumulation describes a market that has since changed direction.

11.1.5 What your result actually means for a decision

High share, well above the national 0.59%. You are in Chapter 8's situation locally, even if your state was not in Chapter 8. Chapter 12 is written for you — read the disposition signals and be ready to act on them.

Near or below the national figure. You are in Chapter 9 or 10 territory. Buy on the numbers, ignore the Act as a variable, and put your attention on carrying cost.

No data returned for your ZIP. This is the case people misread most often. Parcl's own documentation warns that **coverage at very granular levels may be limited in certain areas**. A blank is a coverage gap. It is not a finding that institutional ownership in your ZIP is zero, and you should not treat it as one — step up to the county level and read that instead.

11.1.6 The free cross-check nobody mentions

Your county appraisal district or assessor publishes ownership records, and they are free.

Pull the ownership rows for a few streets you are actually considering. You will see whether the houses around your target are held by individuals or by entities. That is real, local, current information about the specific block you care about, and no national dataset can give it to you.

And it will mislead you if you over-read it. An LLC on a deed tells you nothing about the size of the portfolio behind it — most rental LLCs in this country belong to somebody with three houses, not three hundred. You also cannot see the things Chapter 7 listed: the adviser relationships, the general partner control chains, the

25% equity holders. The name on the deed is the bottom of the structure, not the top.

Use it to answer “is this street owned by people or by companies,” which it can answer. Do not use it to answer “is that company regulated by this Act,” which it cannot.

11.1.7 One more caution, then the useful part

Parcel’s portfolio segmentation is **algorithmic** — an inference from records, not a registry that anyone files with. It is the best available, and it is not a ledger.

You now have three chapters of tiers, a method for checking your own ZIP, and a clear statement of what that method cannot tell you.

Chapter 12 is the one you bought the book for: what to actually do when institutional inventory comes up for sale, and how to recognise it in a listing before anyone else does.

Sources for this chapter. Free-tier credit allowance, paid-tier pricing, the free market-search endpoint, market coverage, the 2019 and 2010 data start dates, the Python SDK and cookbook, the Housing Intelligence Reports county and ZIP levels, and the definition of Large Institutional Share at 1,000-plus properties are all from Parcel Labs’ own published documentation and product pages, retrieved September 2026. Pricing and free-tier limits are commercial terms subject to change and are dated for that reason. The four-bucket investor segmentation (2–9, 10–99, 100–999, 1,000+) and the granular-coverage caveat are likewise from Parcel’s documentation. Parcel Labs is a **commercial data vendor**, cited throughout this book as such and not as a government source; its investor research is used by the Wall Street Journal, Moody’s

Analytics and ResiClub, which speaks to its standing but does not make it official data.

Chapter 12

Buying in the Gap

Chapter 1 established that this Act compels nobody to sell. There is no divestiture requirement, no forced disposal, no seven-year clock. Every institution holding homes on January 6, 2027 may hold them until 2042 and beyond.

And they started selling anyway.

Not because the law made them. Because the people who run these portfolios read the bill in January, ran the arithmetic on a business whose growth engine was about to be switched off, and repriced the policy months before it took effect. That is the most important behavioural fact in this book, and it changes what this chapter can promise you.

12.1.1 What already happened on the buy side

Large-investor purchasing fell from roughly **250 homes a day to roughly 100** in the months after a federal ban was first floated in January 2026 — **a 60% drop before the law took effect at all.**

Read that again in terms of your own bidding. If you lost a house to an institutional buyer in 2025 and have been waiting for January 7, 2027 to change your odds, **most of that change already happened, in 2026, while you were waiting.**

12.1.2 What already happened on the sell side

By July 2026, institutional listings had **more than doubled** — roughly **9,447 homes listed against 4,166 in early February**, a 2.3-fold increase, with a combined asking value near **\$3.1 billion**. The seven largest landlords had gone **3,180 homes net to the sell side since January 1**. And the 350-plus cohort accounted for something on the order of **40% of all net selling** year to date.

That is the gap in the title of this chapter. It opened early.

12.1.3 “Wall Street is selling” is mostly one or two firms

The aggregate hides something that matters more to you than the aggregate does.

Among the seven largest landlords, the selling is wildly uneven. **VineBrook had nearly 10% of its portfolio on the market — roughly 1,900 homes, about \$285 million in asking price**. Invitation Homes had 549 listed. AMH had 536. And **Progress Residential, the largest landlord of them all, had 143**.

VineBrook alone accounts for something like 60% of the net figure. This is not an industry-wide exit. It is one operator repositioning hard, two more trimming, and the biggest holder of all barely moving.

What that means for you is geographic. A portfolio disposition follows the portfolio, so the inventory appears where the selling operator happens to own — not evenly across the concentrated metros. If your market is one where VineBrook was heavy, you will see this. If it is one where Progress dominates, you may see almost nothing, whatever the national headline says.

12.1.4 The caveat, before you plan around any of it

These figures are single-source, and the source sells the data.

The listing counts, the net-selling share and the daily purchase decline come from commercial research firms publishing analysis of their own proprietary datasets, reported through the business press in July 2026. Every figure quoted here has been checked against the published report itself, so the numbers are what the source says. That is not the same as checking the source against deed records, which no reader and no government dataset can currently do for this period.

And the report does not fully reconcile internally. As Chapter 6 sets out, its 589,000 homes, 3.9% and 14 million rentals cannot all be correct together. That is a reason to hold the magnitudes loosely, not a reason to discard the direction. They carry the entire timing argument of this chapter and they rest on nobody's methodology but the vendor's.

They are consistent with each other, which is worth something — two firms measuring different things, arriving at the same direction. That is not the same as confirmation.

Treat the direction as reliable and the magnitude as approximate. If you plan a purchase on the assumption that exactly 40% of net selling is institutional, you have over-read what anyone actually knows.

12.1.5 What this means for your timing

Honestly: **you are not early.**

A book about a law taking effect in January 2027 wants to tell you that the opportunity is ahead of you. The evidence says a sub-

stantial part of the repositioning is behind you, and what remains is the tail of it rather than the front.

That is still worth acting on, for two reasons. Institutional portfolios are large and disposals run over years, not months — the seven largest landlords still hold roughly **400,000 homes between them**, so a net 3,180 is **eight tenths of one percent** of what they own. And the buy-side collapse is structural: after January 7, covered entities cannot resume, whatever the market does. **The bidder does not come back.**

So the correct framing is not “get in before the wave.” It is: **the competitive landscape has already changed, permanently, and most small operators have not adjusted their expectations to it.**

12.1.6 How to recognise an institutional disposition in a listing

You will not see a badge. You have to read the pattern, and these are the signals, strongest first.

Price cuts. The institutional cohort ran a **54% price-cut rate against 38.7% nationally** — a 15-point spread, roughly 1.4 times the national rate. These are sellers optimising for exit velocity across a portfolio, not homeowners defending a number they need for their next purchase. A listing that cuts early and cuts again is behaving like inventory, not like somebody’s house.

And the cuts were getting deeper. Markdowns across the cohort widened from about 3.1% to about 4% of asking value between early May and late July 2026. A seller whose discount is growing month over month is telling you something about how badly the inventory needs to clear.

Clustering. Institutional disposal shows up as several homes

listing in the same ZIP in the same few weeks. One house is a coincidence. Six in a quarter-mile is a portfolio decision. In named south-Atlanta ZIP codes, roughly **a quarter of all listed supply** has been institutional disposition.

The house is newer than its neighbours. Institutional single-family holdings skew newer than the surrounding stock in nearly every metro studied — Cincinnati is the exception. A 2004 house on a street of 1978 houses is worth a second look.

Three bedrooms. Median institutional holdings are three-bedroom homes, the same as the overall single-family median. This signal is weak on its own and useful only alongside the others.

A tenant in place. Institutional sales frequently list occupied. For a buyer who wants immediate income and does not need to occupy, that is a feature; for a buyer using owner-occupant financing, it is disqualifying.

The seller name on the deed record. Free at your county assessor, as Chapter 11 described — and subject to the same limit, that an entity name tells you about the bottom of a structure, not the top.

12.1.7 The counter-argument you should hear from me rather than from a critic

When an institution lists a home, **the most likely buyer is another investor, not a family.**

Investor purchases rose from roughly **27% of all sales in 2019 to 37–39% by late 2025**, while investor-to-owner-occupant sales **fell from about 32% to 20–23%**. The homes institutions release are largely being bought by other investors — smaller ones, the Act permits it, and Chapter 3’s exception (H) expressly allows covered entities to sell to each other.

This matters to you in two ways, and they point in opposite directions.

It weakens the public case for the law. If the stated purpose was returning homes to families, the flow data does not yet show that happening.

And it describes your actual competition. The person you are bidding against for an institutional disposal is not Invitation Homes. It is another operator roughly your size, with roughly your financing, reading roughly the same signals. The advantage does not come from knowing the gap exists. It comes from being able to close faster than the other small operator who also knows.

12.1.8 What the flow data says about you

Between March 2024 and January 2026, while the 1,000-plus portfolios were net sellers shedding roughly **4,010 units** and the 100–999 portfolios were down **2,246**, one cohort was buying.

Portfolios of two to nine units added roughly 3,485 homes — growing to 102.8% of their March 2024 base.

The only tier gaining ground was the one this Act does not regulate at all. The small operator was already winning on net flows, before the ban, without the statute's help.

That is the least dramatic finding in this book and possibly the most useful. The law did not create your opportunity. It removed a competitor from a lane you were already gaining in.

Chapter 13 deals with the side of this that decides whether you can actually act on any of it: the money.

[EDITORIAL NOTE — Maurice: two decisions embedded here. First, I stated the single-source caveat in the body

rather than burying it, because this chapter's figures are the ones a hostile reviewer would go after first; the notes flagged them as needing direct verification with the vendor and that has not been done. If you can verify them before publication, the caveat paragraph can soften. If not, it stays as written. Second, this chapter makes the case for speed of close as the small operator's edge without naming a lender or mentioning Dominion Hard Money. The book is worth more to that business as a credible book than as a brochure. Chapter 13 can reference financing types generally on the same principle. Say the word if you want it played differently.]

Sources for this chapter. Institutional listing counts (9,447 versus 4,166), the \$3.1 billion combined asking value, the 3,180 net homes sold by the seven largest landlords since January 1, the 54% institutional price-cut rate against 38.7% nationally, and the roughly 40% share of net selling are from CNBC's Property Play reporting of Parcl Labs data, July 21, 2026 — **commercial vendor research reported through the business press**, single-source and not independently verified by this book. The decline in large-investor purchasing from roughly 250 to 100 homes per day is from AllStreet Capital, July 6, 2026, likewise single-source. Portfolio-tier net flows for March 2024 – January 2026, the ZIP-level disposition share in south Atlanta, and the property characteristics (newer stock, three-bedroom median, Cincinnati exception) are from Parcl Labs' published research. Investor share of purchases and the investor-to-owner-occupant sales trend are from the same body of vendor research. All figures current as of September 2026 and subject to revision by their publishers.

Chapter 13

The Money Side

This Act closes one door and leaves another one open, and almost nobody writing about it has noticed which is which.

It bars a category of buyer from purchasing homes. It says nothing about lending against them.

Chapter 2 established the mechanism: the statute's definition of investment control **expressly excludes debt investments**. An entity that lends money secured by a single-family home has not purchased that home and does not accumulate it toward the 350 threshold. Capital that could previously buy houses at scale can still finance houses at scale, on January 8, 2027, exactly as it could the day before.

Two consequences follow, and they point in opposite directions for you.

Financing may get easier. Capital that wants exposure to single-family residential and can no longer take it through ownership has one obvious remaining route. Money looking for a home tends to find one.

And your competition may be funded by the same institutions that can no longer bid against you. The other small operator reading the same listing signals from Chapter 12 may be borrowing from a balance sheet that used to buy directly. The capital does not leave the asset class. It changes seats.

The caution from Chapter 2 applies with force here. The debt exclusion is not a costume. A transaction structured as a loan that

functions as an equity purchase — control of the property, upside on the sale, the borrower a formality — is an equity purchase with a loan document stapled to it. That structure is untested against this statute, and being first to test it is not a position you want as a small operator.

13.1.1 What the exceptions do to your competition

Chapter 3 catalogued eleven exceptions. One of them changes what you compete for.

Exception (C), renovate-to-rent, lets a covered entity buy a home with deficient core systems **provided it commits at least 15% of the purchase price to improvements**. On a \$180,000 house, that is a **\$27,000 floor** — not a target, a condition of the exception applying at all.

So a covered entity looking at a marginal distressed property has to ask whether the deal still works with that spend attached. On many marginal properties it does not. **The lightly distressed house — the one needing \$8,000 of work rather than \$30,000 — sits in a gap where the exception is expensive to use and the general prohibition applies.**

That is your lane, and it is a lane the statute created without meaning to.

13.1.2 Why speed beats price on a disposition

Chapter 12 established that institutional sellers cut prices at **54% against 38.7% nationally**. That is not distress. That is a seller optimising for exit velocity across a portfolio, marking to whatever clears.

A seller in that posture is not primarily choosing the highest num-

ber. **They are choosing the offer most likely to close, on the date it says it will close.** A portfolio disposition manager with quarterly targets will take less money from a buyer who closes in twelve days over more money from a buyer whose lender needs forty-five and may re-trade at the appraisal.

This is the whole of the small operator's edge, and it is worth being precise about what it is not. It is not knowing the gap exists — Chapter 12 explained that your real competition is another operator who read the same signals. **It is having your financing arranged before you write the offer.**

13.1.3 Three shapes of money, and why no rates appear in this book

Agency and conventional financing. The cheapest money available and the slowest, with the tightest underwriting. It is often simply unavailable on the listings Chapter 12 taught you to spot, because an occupied property with a tenant in place disqualifies most owner-occupant products outright.

DSCR lending. Qualifies the property rather than the borrower, sizing the loan against the income the house produces. It is the natural instrument for a rental purchase and the one where book one's cost research does the most work — for reasons the next section makes arithmetic.

Short-term and bridge financing, secured by value rather than income. Faster to close, materially more expensive, and structured with a draw schedule when renovation is involved. This is the instrument that buys speed, and speed is what the disposition seller is actually paying for. It is not cheap money and should not be held long; the exit is a refinance into longer-term debt once the property is stabilised and producing.

No interest rates, loan-to-value limits or points appear anywhere in this book. They would be stale before it reached you, and a reader who planned around a printed rate from September 2026 would be planning around a number that no longer exists. Price your money locally, at the time you need it.

13.1.4 How the property qualifies itself

DSCR is one division: **net operating income divided by annual debt service**. A ratio of 1.00 means the property exactly covers its loan payments and nothing else. Lenders generally want a cushion above that.

Here is what that cushion means in practice, using a 1.25 target and three cost profiles drawn from book one’s state research. Same method, three states.

Profile	Monthly rent	Annual NOI	Max debt service at 1.25 DSCR
Ohio-type	\$1,650	~\$11,759	~\$9,407/yr — about \$784/month
Atlanta-type	\$1,850	~\$12,090	~\$9,672/yr — about \$806/month
Florida-type	\$2,100	~\$9,293	~\$7,435/yr — about \$620/month

Illustrative, using an 8% vacancy allowance, 8% management, and the state cost levels from The Landlord’s Cost Map. Your figures will differ.

Look at the Florida row. It has the highest rent of the three by a wide margin — \$2,100 a month against Ohio’s \$1,650 — and it supports **the smallest loan**.

The reason is the insurance line: roughly **\$7,136** a year for \$300,000 of coverage on a Florida property, against a national average near **\$2,543**, the finding book one led with and Chapter 8 carried into this one. Rent of \$2,100 does not survive it.

This is the book’s central caution rendered as arithmetic. **A**

house you win because Wall Street can no longer bid on it can still fail on carrying cost. The institutional bidder leaving improves your odds of getting the house. It does nothing whatever to the insurance premium, the property tax rate or the age of the roof, and those decide whether owning it is worth having won it.

13.1.5 Draw schedules, briefly

When renovation is financed, the money arrives in stages against completed work rather than in a lump at closing. Budget for the gap: you fund the work, then get reimbursed on inspection, which means you need working capital the loan amount does not describe. Operators who plan only to the loan total discover this in week three.

13.1.6 Where to get the numbers this chapter needs

The NOI line in that table is not a financing question. It is a property tax rate, an insurance premium, a vacancy assumption, a maintenance reserve set against the age of the building, and a management cost — state by state, county by county, sometimes town by town, as Connecticut's seven-to-one spread showed in Chapter 10.

That research is book one, and this book deliberately does not reprint it. *The Landlord's Cost Map* works through all fifty states on exactly those lines. **Get your carrying costs from there or from your own county, and bring them to this chapter.** A DSCR calculation built on guessed operating expenses is a guess with a decimal point on it.

Chapter 14 turns to the part of this Act that was supposed to help small landlords directly — and to the money that was never

appropriated for it.

Chapter 14

The Act's Own Small Landlord — and the Money That Isn't There

The same statute that removes the largest buyer from your market names the smallest one and offers him a forgivable loan.

That pairing is the spine of this book. **Section 1001 defines the institutional investor at 350 or more homes. Section 202 defines an eligible landlord at fewer than ten properties.** One law, two definitions, pointing in opposite directions — and as far as this book can find, nobody has written about the second one for the people it describes.

There is a reason for that, and it arrives in the middle of this chapter.

14.1.1 What §202 says

The Whole-Home Repairs provision, sponsored by Representative Troy Downing of Montana, defines an **eligible landlord** as an individual who owns **fewer than ten eligible rental properties**, with **a majority of units affordable** and **not more than twenty-five total units**, operated as primary residences.

If that describes you — and for most readers of this book it does — the provision contemplates **forgivable loans** for repairs. Forgivable in full three years after the repairs are completed, provided you have kept the terms of the loan agreement. The section also provides grants to eligible homeowners at or below 80% of area

median income. The programme terminates **October 1, 2031**.

Read against the rest of this book, that is a remarkable thing to find in the same law. The reader who has spent thirteen chapters learning that a 350-home threshold does not describe him arrives at a provision that describes him precisely.

14.1.2 The strings, which are substantial

Before the disappointment, the conditions, because they matter to whether you would want this even if it existed.

- **Offer to extend current tenants' leases on current terms for three years.**
- **Keep a unit affordable for the remainder of that three-year term if a tenant leaves.**
- **Document code compliance after the renovation.**
- **Attest to no serious renter-protection violations in the preceding ten years.**
- **Cap annual rent increases at 5% or inflation, whichever is lower, for three years.**

That last one deserves a moment. A three-year rent cap set at the lower of 5% or inflation is a real constraint on a property you have just improved — improvements being the ordinary justification for raising rent. Whether a forgivable repair loan is worth three years of capped increases and a three-year lease commitment is a calculation, not an obvious yes. Run it against your own numbers before you want this.

14.1.3 And now the part that matters

There is no money.

Section 1202 of this Act is one sentence long, and it is sweeping: **no additional funds are authorised to be appropriated** to carry out the requirements of the Act or any amendment made by it. That covers every title and every programme in the statute.

The Bipartisan Policy Center’s implementation tracker records **“No funding authorized”** against §202 outright. The Urban Institute names Whole-Home Repairs specifically as depending on a future appropriations bill with no guarantee it arrives. One law firm’s analysis warns the provision may wither as an unfunded pilot.

So the loan is authorised and unfunded. Those are different words and this book will not blur them. As of publication there is no programme to apply to, no HUD guidance to read and no money to receive. The definition of you exists in federal law. The appropriation does not.

14.1.4 What was taken out, and how you can verify it

This is the finding in this chapter that you will not read anywhere else, and it is checkable against the enrolled text in an afternoon.

The money was in the bill. It was removed before enactment.

The Senate’s ROAD to Housing Act of 2025 carried this provision at §204 with a funding subsection authorising HUD to use **up to \$30,000,000** from Office of Lead Hazard Control and Healthy Homes appropriations, along with a reporting requirement to the Appropriations and Banking committees naming the accounts. The standalone bills carried it too — H.R. 5990 at \$30 million, S. 127 at \$25 million.

The enacted §202 has no funding subsection at all.

And the paragraph numbering is the fingerprint. The enrolled

text runs (10) Reporting requirements, (11) Environmental review, (12) Termination, and then straight on to Section 203. In H.R. 5990, environmental review sat at (12) — *after* the funding paragraph. The numbers shifted up because the money came out.

You do not have to take that on my word. Pull the enrolled bill from govinfo, pull H.R. 5990, and read the two paragraph sequences side by side.

14.1.5 Why this correction is aimed at you specifically

The advocacy world publicised the \$30 million, and those pages are still live.

Organisations campaigning for home repair funding describe up to \$30 million available through October 1, 2031, as though the provision survived intact. A small landlord searching for repair assistance today will find those pages, read a real dollar figure attached to a real section of a real law that really passed, and conclude the money is there.

It is not. Not reduced, not delayed — removed before the President declined to sign, and the pages describing it have not been updated.

That is exactly the shape of correction that made book one worth writing: a specific, checkable number that a reasonable person would rely on and that is wrong.

14.1.6 One nuance, so the chapter is not overstated

Section 1202's blanket language does **not** nullify every specific authorisation in the Act. The Innovation Fund's authorisation of \$200

million a year for fiscal years 2027 through 2031 is being read as operative by housing finance and legal analysts, on the ordinary principle that a specific provision governs over a general one.

So the correct statement is narrower than “the Act funds nothing,” and narrower is what this book prints. **Section 202 in particular carries no funding authorisation of its own, and the general provision leaves it with nothing to stand on.**

14.1.7 What to actually do about it

Watch appropriations, not the housing news. Whether this provision ever becomes real is decided in a fiscal year 2027 appropriations bill, not by HUD and not by anything that happens on January 7.

The lobbying is live. BPC Action published a letter around September 1, 2026 urging FY2027 appropriators to fund implementation, naming §102 and §202 specifically. As of this writing the provision is authorised, unfunded, and actively being argued for.

And do not build a repair plan around it. If the roof needs replacing in 2027, finance it the way Chapter 13 describes. If the appropriation arrives later, that is a windfall. It is not a plan.

14.1.8 A closing note on citations

This provision has been numbered four different ways: **§203** in one policy explainer, **§204** in the Senate’s 2025 bill, **§5204** in S. 2296, and **§202** as enacted. Four numbers, one provision.

Chapter 5 argued that most disagreement about this law is disagreement about definitions. The same thing is true of its citations. When you go to verify anything in this chapter — and you should

— go to the enrolled text at govinfo, not to a summary, however reputable the firm that wrote it.

Chapter 15 covers what else is in the Act, and applies the same funded-or-not test to each of it.

Sources for this chapter. The eligible-landlord definition, loan forgiveness terms, tenant and rent-cap conditions, and the October 1, 2031 termination are from the enrolled text of P.L. 119-101 §202 (BILLS-119hr6644enr, govinfo), with the definition independently confirmed by Holland & Knight. The absence of a funding subsection is established by direct comparison of the enrolled text against H.R. 5990 and the Senate’s ROAD to Housing Act of 2025 §204, including the paragraph renumbering described above — **an original finding of this book, verifiable by any reader against both texts.** The \$30 million and \$25 million figures are from those prior bills. “No funding authorized” against §202 is from the Bipartisan Policy Center’s implementation tracker; the dependence on future appropriations is from Urban Institute (June 30, 2026) and KJK (July 10, 2026); the absence of funding across the Act generally is from Morgan Lewis (July 2026). The Innovation Fund’s \$200 million annual authorisation for FY2027–2031 being read as operative is from NCSHA and Holland & Knight. The FY2027 appropriations letter is BPC Action, circa September 1, 2026. All current as of September 2026 — **and this is the chapter of this book most likely to change.**

Chapter 15

Everything Else in the Act, Labelled

The purchase ban is one section of a large statute. Fourteen chapters have been spent on §1001 because it is the part that changes your competitive position, but a reader who closes the book here would think this was a bill about institutional investors. It is not. It is a housing bill with an institutional investor provision in it.

The rest matters unevenly, and the useful skill is telling which parts are real today from which parts are a press release with a section number.

So every provision below carries a status label. Four of them:

- **LIVE** — in effect now, usable today
- **EFFECTIVE ON A DATE** — certain, with the date given
- **DISCRETIONARY** — the statute says the Secretary *may*, not *shall*
- **AUTHORISED, UNFUNDED** — exists in law, has no money behind it

Apply that test to anything anyone tells you about this Act, including the provisions in this chapter.

15.1.1 The one you can use in the next month

§104 — searchable databases of undeveloped publicly-owned parcels. LIVE - effective October 1, 2026.

Community Development Block Grant recipients must publish searchable databases of undeveloped publicly-owned land. That is a real, free, checkable inventory of land that a public body owns and is not using, in every CDBG jurisdiction in the country.

Of everything in this chapter, **this is the provision most likely to put a deal in front of you**, and it costs nothing but the time to look. It is also the provision nobody is writing about, because it is administrative rather than dramatic.

Find your CDBG entitlement jurisdiction — your city or your county — and look for the database.

15.1.2 Effective already

§103 — NEPA exemption for USDA infill housing. EFFECTIVE ON ENACTMENT.

Infill housing developments served by existing infrastructure are exempted from certain federal environmental review. That removes real time and cost from small rural and small-town development.

Read the definition before you rely on it. Infill here **excludes** greenfield sites, sites served only by a road, and census tracts rated very high or relatively high risk for wildfire, coastal flooding or riverine flooding under FEMA's National Risk Index. Those exclusions are not incidental — they rule out a good deal of the land that looks cheapest.

15.1.3 Financing provisions you can actually reach

§303 — ADU construction as an acceptable use for FHA property-improvement loans, and increased FHA-insured manufactured housing loan limits.

Both are directly usable by a small operator, and the ADU provision is the more interesting of the two: adding a unit to a property you already own is a route to scale that never appears on the MLS and that no institutional buyer is competing with you for.

Note the interaction with Chapter 2. **Manufactured homes are excluded from the Act's definition of a single-family home**, so a manufactured housing purchase sits entirely outside the ban — for you and for everyone else. The higher FHA limits are the relevant change there, not §1001.

§101 — housing counseling for borrowers thirty or more days delinquent, funded from the Mutual Mortgage Insurance Fund where the statutory conditions are met. Relevant if you hold FHA-financed property and hit trouble.

15.1.4 The one that is not what the summaries say

§105 — the FHA small-dollar mortgage pilot. DISCRETIONARY.

You will see this listed as a win for small investors. **It is not available for rental property.**

Section 105(e) defines a small-dollar mortgage as one with an original principal balance of \$100,000 or less **and secured by a one- to four-unit property that is the principal residence of the mortgagor.** A landlord cannot use it for a rental. The property has to be where the borrower lives.

Three further limits worth knowing. Section 105(a) says the Secretary **may** establish the pilot — discretionary, not mandatory. The pilot sunsets four years after establishment. And the authority to newly establish it expires after three years.

So the accurate description is: a discretionary pilot, for owner-occupants, that may never be established. If a summary told you otherwise, that summary is why this book has a labelling rule.

15.1.5 Capital availability, indirectly

§203 — the public welfare investment cap raised from 15% to 20% for national banks and state member banks. This does not touch your loan application. It widens what banks may put into qualifying housing investment, and over time that shows up as capital availability rather than as a product you apply for.

§§908 and 909 — de novo community bank support and a rural depository study. Slow-moving and genuinely relevant to a small operator, because community banks are where small operators in small markets get loans. A study is a study; the de novo support is the substantive half.

15.1.6 Authorised, unfunded, or discretionary

§102 — point-access block guidelines and HUD pilot grants. Single-stair building guidance, with a grant programme that sunsets seven years after enactment. Read the funding status before planning around the grants.

The Innovation Fund carries an authorisation of **\$200 million a year for fiscal years 2027 through 2031**, and analysts read that specific authorisation as operative notwithstanding §1202's general language, on the principle that a specific provision governs over a general one. That makes it the exception to Chapter 14's finding, not a refutation of it.

§202 — Whole-Home Repairs. AUTHORISED, UNFUNDED. Chapter 14 in full.

15.1.7 Not a housing provision at all

Title XI, §1101 — Central Bank Digital Currency.

It has nothing to do with your business and it is in this Act. It is

here for one reason: so that no reader can tell you this book called the ROAD to Housing Act a purely housing bill and was wrong. Legislation of this size carries passengers.

15.1.8 A separate lever, not part of this Act

Executive Order 14376's GSE and FHA financing channel operates independently of the purchase ban and on its own timeline. Different instrument, different authority, different things that can undo it — an executive order can be revoked by the next signature, which a statute cannot.

15.1.9 One date, two halves of the Act

January 7, 2027 is the day the purchase prohibition takes effect. It is also the deadline — 180 days from enactment — by which **HUD must establish eligibility criteria for §202**, the small-landlord repair provision.

So on the same day the statute removes the largest buyer from your market, it is due to publish the criteria defining you as the smallest. One of those halves has money behind it and one does not, which is the most honest summary of this Act available in a sentence.

Chapter 16 asks the question this book has been circling: whether any of it will work.

Sources for this chapter. All provisions and their terms are from the enrolled text of PL. 119-101 (BILLS-119hr6644enr, gov-info): §101 housing counseling; §102 point-access block guidelines and grant sunset; §103 the USDA infill NEPA exemption

and its exclusion of greenfields, road-only sites and FEMA National Risk Index high-risk tracts; §104 the CDBG parcel database requirement effective October 1, 2026; §105(a) and §105(e) the small-dollar pilot's discretionary character and its principal-residence limitation; §203 the 15% to 20% public welfare investment cap; §303 ADU eligibility and manufactured housing loan limits; §§908–909 de novo bank support and the rural depository study; and Title XI §1101. Section-by-section confirmation is from Holland & Knight (August 2026). The Innovation Fund's \$200 million annual authorisation for FY2027–2031 being read as operative is from NCSHA and Holland & Knight. Funding statuses are cross-checked against the Bipartisan Policy Center implementation tracker. Executive Order 14376 is cited as a separate instrument and not as part of this Act. All current as of September 2026.

Chapter 16

Why This May Not Work

A book that sells you an opportunity has an obvious incentive not to write this chapter. Here it is anyway, because the reasons this law might fail are also the reasons your own plans might fail, and you are better off holding them now than discovering them in 2028.

Nine arguments, strongest first.

16.1.1 1. Enforcement runs on self-reporting

Covered entities must **notify the Secretary of HUD annually** of their status as a large institutional investor, identifying the number of single-family homes under their direct or indirect investment control and the city and state of each — with a carve-out where the investor owns ten or fewer homes in a given city.

Read that mechanism carefully. **The filing obligation attaches to entities that consider themselves covered.** An entity that has arranged its affairs so that no single legal person holds 350 homes does not file, and nothing in the reporting scheme surfaces it. The government learns about the entities that tell it.

That is not unusual in federal regulation, and it is not nothing — the penalties are real at **\$1 million per violation or three times the purchase price**. But enforcement of a threshold nobody independently measures, against entities that self-declare, is a weaker instrument than the headline suggests.

16.1.2 2. There is still no rule

As of September 2026, **no proposed Treasury rule has appeared.** Law firm alerts through the summer continue to advise clients that the practical impact will depend on forthcoming regulations.

The prohibition takes effect January 7, 2027. The agency charged with implementing it — Treasury, in consultation with HUD, the FHFA and the SEC — has published nothing with four months to run.

This is the most perishable fact in this book. If you are reading it after publication, check the current status before relying on this section.

16.1.3 3. Restructuring

The industry's own analysts said this out loud within days of Senate passage. Steve Murray, a longtime real estate analyst, called the 350 threshold arbitrary — his blunt assessment was that the figure had simply been invented — and argued that sophisticated investors could simply spread ownership across multiple entities to stay underneath it.

The statute anticipates this. The definition reaches entities acting **“in concert with one or more other entities,”** and Chapter 2 walked through the three prongs of investment control that follow control chains through general partners, managing members, advisers and 25% equity holders.

Whether that language is strong enough is untested and will be tested. It will be tested by law firms with more resources than the agency writing the rule, and the answer will not be known for years.

16.1.4 4. Build-to-rent is exempt

Exception (B) permits covered entities to build homes and rent them. That exception is not a loophole in the sense of an oversight — it was deliberate, on the reasoning that new construction adds supply rather than competing for it.

But consider what it means for the stated goal. **Capital that wanted single-family rental exposure and can no longer buy existing homes can still create them.** Institutional ownership of single-family rental housing does not shrink under that scenario. It changes its source. And the homes built to rent are homes that were never available to a family buyer at all.

16.1.5 5. The debt door

Chapter 13 covered this. **Debt investments are expressly excluded from investment control.** Capital blocked from equity ownership can lend against the same asset class, on the same day, without limit.

16.1.6 6. Institutions may still trade with each other, and largely do

Exception (H) permits a covered entity to purchase from another covered entity. And the GAO's metro-level work found that **at least 30% of institutional acquisitions in every metro studied were homes already institutionally owned before 2018** — in Seattle, roughly 61%.

A large fraction of what gets called institutional buying is institutions trading with each other, which this Act expressly permits.

16.1.7 7. Exception (I) leaves a two-year window inside the ban

Chapter 3 covered this as an opportunity for you. It is equally an argument against the law working as advertised.

For roughly two years after the effective date — until about January 2029 — covered entities may still purchase from investors who are not themselves covered. That is a substantial category, and it is the category that holds most of the smaller portfolios. The ban is not fully a ban until 2029.

16.1.8 8. The homes are not going to families

This is the argument that should trouble a supporter of the law most, and Chapter 12 laid out the data.

Investor purchases rose from roughly **27% of all sales in 2019 to 37–39% by late 2025**, while investor-to-owner-occupant sales **fell from about 32% to 20–23%**. When an institution sells, the buyer is most often another investor.

If the objective was returning homes to owner-occupants, the flow data does not yet show it happening, and nothing in the statute requires it to.

16.1.9 9. The effect may be too small to see

A September 2026 analysis argued the market has not noticed and will not: large investors are a small share of national purchases even in the Sun Belt, so removing them from the bid is unlikely to register in aggregate price data.

Chapter 7 supports that arithmetically. **Roughly 0.59% of single-family homes are held by the regulated cohort.** A change to a bidder representing well under 1% of the stock is difficult to

detect in national prices, and anyone who claims to have detected it in 2027 is probably reading noise.

16.1.10 And an attribution problem underneath all of it

The buy-side collapse happened **in 2026, before the law took effect** — large investor purchasing fell from roughly 250 homes a day to 100 after a federal ban was first floated in January.

So if institutional buying is low in 2028, what caused it? The statute, or an industry that had already repriced and moved on? **The law will likely be credited with a change that substantially preceded it**, and that will make honest evaluation of whether it worked nearly impossible.

16.1.11 What is not in doubt

Set against all of that, three things are solid.

The bidder does not come back. Whatever the market does, a covered entity cannot resume buying existing single-family homes. That is permanent until 2042.

Where concentration is high, the effect is real. A ZIP code above 10% loses a buyer who was genuinely setting the price on the houses you want. National averages hide that; Chapter 8 does not.

And the definitions are now fixed in law. Whatever anyone means by “institutional investor” in conversation, one number has legal force. That was true of nothing in this debate two years ago.

16.1.12 How you will know

Do not evaluate this law by the headlines in January 2027. Watch four things.

Does Treasury issue a rule, and does it reach control structures or only named owners? That single question decides more than any other.

Does the reporting produce a public count? If HUD publishes what it receives, the measurement problem in Chapters 5 through 7 partly solves itself. If it does not, everyone stays in the dark and the vendors keep owning the numbers.

Does the 350-to-999 cohort grow? A sudden proliferation of entities holding 340 homes is the restructuring argument proved right.

Does anything actually reach owner-occupants? The investor-to-owner-occupant share is the number that tells you whether the stated purpose was achieved. It is published, and it is currently going the wrong way.

Chapter 17 gives you the calendar for watching all of it.

Sources for this chapter. The annual HUD notification requirement, the city-level reporting detail and its ten-home carve-out, the renter outreach obligations, and the allocation of rulemaking to Treasury in consultation with HUD, FHFA and the SEC are from Greenberg Traurig’s analysis of the enacted Act (July 2026) and the enrolled text at §1001. The absence of a proposed Treasury rule is stated as of September 2026, based on the state of published law firm guidance, which continues to describe regulations as forthcoming — **readers should verify current status**. The restructuring argument and the characterisation of the threshold as

arbitrary are from HousingWire’s reporting of analyst Steve Murray, March 2026. *Note that the same article describes a seven-year disposal requirement; as Chapter 4 established, that provision was stripped by House amendment on May 20, 2026 and is not in the enacted law — the article predates the amendment.* GAO-26-108675 supplies the pre-2018 institutional ownership shares. Investor purchase and investor-to-owner-occupant sales trends, and the 2026 decline in daily purchasing, are from the vendor research described in Chapter 12, with the single-source caveat stated there applying equally here. The aggregate-price argument is from a September 7, 2026 market analysis. All current as of September 2026.

Chapter 17

What to Watch, and When

Everything in this book has a date attached, which means everything in it expires. This chapter is the calendar, and then the part that does not expire.

17.1.1 The dates

October 1, 2026 — §104 parcel databases go live. Community Development Block Grant recipients must publish searchable databases of undeveloped publicly-owned parcels. This is the earliest thing on the calendar and the only one you can act on immediately. Find your CDBG jurisdiction and look.

Fiscal year 2027 appropriations — whether §202 becomes real. The Whole-Home Repairs provision is authorised and unfunded. It becomes a programme only if appropriators fund it, and advocates were actively lobbying for exactly that as of September 2026. **Watch the appropriations bill, not the housing news.**

January 7, 2027 — the ban takes effect, and HUD's §202 deadline falls. Two halves of the same statute land on one day. Covered entities may no longer purchase existing single-family homes. HUD is due to establish eligibility criteria for the small-landlord repair provision — the 180-day mark from enactment. One half is self-executing. The other needs money that does not exist.

Whenever it appears — the Treasury rule. No proposed rule

existed as of September 2026. When one arrives, the question that matters is whether it reaches control structures — general partners, advisers, 25% equity holders, entities acting in concert — or only names on deeds. **That single question decides more about this law’s effect than anything else on this calendar.**

Roughly January 2029 — exception (I) closes. For about two years after the effective date, covered entities may still purchase from investors who are not themselves covered. If you are a small operator who has been considering an exit, that window has a deadline attached and it is the only deadline in this Act that runs against you personally.

December 31, 2030 — the CBDC prohibition sunsets. Nothing to do with your business. Noted because it is in the same statute and you should not be surprised by it.

October 1, 2031 — §202 terminates. If it is never funded, it expires without having existed. If it is funded, this is the outside date for using it.

Roughly January 2042 — §1001 sunsets. Fifteen years. A long time in a business measured in five-year holds, and worth remembering that the prohibition is not permanent.

17.1.2 Where to look

The enrolled text, at govinfo. Everything in this book is checkable against [BILLS-119hr6644enr](#). Chapter 14’s finding about the stripped funding requires comparing it against H.R. 5990, which is also there. **Go to the statute before you go to a summary** — Chapter 5 counted four different section numbers for one provision across five reputable sources.

The Bipartisan Policy Center implementation tracker. Section-by-section, with funding status and regulatory deadlines,

and it is maintained. It is the single best place to see what has moved since this book was printed.

The Federal Register, for the Treasury rule when it comes.

Parcel's Housing Intelligence Reports, for re-checking your own ZIP as described in Chapter 11 — with the standing caution that the metric is defined at 1,000-plus properties and therefore reports a floor, not the statute's threshold.

Your county assessor, for what is actually happening on the streets you buy on. Free, current, local, and limited in exactly the way Chapter 11 described.

17.1.3 Your own calendar

Five things, in order.

Now: check whether the Act is even about your market. Chapter 11's method, against your own ZIP. Most readers will find they are in Chapter 10's tier, and knowing that saves you from planning around an effect you will never see.

Now: pull your carrying costs. Property tax rate, insurance, the age of the building. That is book one's work and it decides your deals regardless of what any institution does.

Before January 7: have your financing arranged, not re-searched. Chapter 13's argument was that the disposition seller pays for certainty of closing, and that advantage belongs to the buyer whose money is already lined up when the listing appears.

Through 2027: watch the rule and the appropriation. Two questions, both answerable from the sources above, neither requiring you to follow the news daily.

Annually: re-check your ZIP. Concentration moves, and the direction is currently downward in the markets that had the most.

17.1.4 What this book will get wrong

Being specific about this is more useful than a disclaimer.

Chapter 14 is the most perishable. If §202 is funded, its central finding — that the money was stripped — remains historically true but stops being the practical answer.

Chapter 16's second argument dies the day Treasury publishes. And the content of that rule may change several other chapters with it.

Chapter 12's figures are single-source, from firms that sell the data, and this book has not independently verified them.

Chapter 11's commercial terms are commercial terms. Free-tier credits and pricing change without notice.

Everything else in the book rests on the enrolled statute, on published government reports, and on arithmetic you can redo.

17.1.5 What you keep

The law will change. A rule will arrive, an appropriation will pass or fail, the concentration numbers will move, and somebody will write a better guide to the 2027 version of all this.

What survives is a habit, and it is the thing this book was actually about.

Read the threshold. GAO says 5,000. Another study says 1,000. A vendor says 1,000. Realtor.com counts purchases, not homes. The statute says 350. Five numbers, five different questions, and almost every public argument about this law is people answering different questions at each other.

Read the denominator. The same firm published 0.59% and 3.9% for the same cohort four months apart, and both were correct. One was a share of all single-family homes; the other was a share of single-family rentals. Nothing changed except what sat

underneath the fraction.

Ask whether it is stock or flow. Homes owned and homes purchased last quarter are different measurements, and flow numbers always look more alarming.

Check the date. A firm called it Title IX. Another called it §901. A trade publication still describes a seven-year disposal requirement that was stripped by amendment in May 2026. Advocacy pages still promote \$30 million that no longer exists. **None of those sources is dishonest. All of them are stale**, and staleness is the ordinary condition of writing about a law that moved through Congress in six months.

Apply those four questions to the next housing statistic anyone puts in front of you, and to anything in this book you have reason to doubt.

That discipline outlasts §1001, and it will still be worth having in 2042.

Sources for this chapter. All statutory dates are from the enrolled text of P.L. 119-101 (BILLS-119hr6644enr, govinfo): the January 7, 2027 effective date and 180-day HUD deadline, §104's October 1, 2026 database requirement, §1001(a)(2)(I)'s two-year window, §202's October 1, 2031 termination, Title XI's December 31, 2030 sunset, and the fifteen-year sunset of the purchase prohibition. Funding statuses are from the Bipartisan Policy Center implementation tracker; the FY2027 lobbying effort is BPC Action, circa September 1, 2026. The absence of a proposed Treasury rule is stated as of September 2026. The four analytical questions in the closing section restate findings established and sourced in Chapters 4 through 7. All current as of September 2026.

Appendix

The Thirty Metros

Every metropolitan area in the published top thirty, ranked by the number of single-family homes held by entities at or above the Act's 350-home threshold. The right-hand column is that count as a share of the metro's **total single-family housing stock** — not its rental stock. Chapter 6 explains why that distinction changes the number by a factor of six or seven.

#	Metro	Homes	Share of SF stock
1	Atlanta–Sandy Springs–Alpharetta, GA	71,625	4.2%
2	Dallas–Fort Worth–Arlington, TX	35,632	1.7%
3	Phoenix–Mesa–Chandler, AZ	30,268	2.2%
4	Charlotte–Concord–Gastonia, NC–SC	28,494	3.4%
5	Houston–The Woodlands–Sugar Land, TX	27,690	1.4%
6	Tampa–St. Petersburg–Clearwater, FL	24,636	2.6%
7	Orlando–Kissimmee–Sanford, FL	19,154	2.6%
8	Jacksonville, FL	18,950	3.6%
9	Indianapolis–Carmel–Anderson, IN	16,856	2.6%
10	Las Vegas–Henderson–Paradise, NV	16,209	2.7%
11	Memphis, TN–MS–AR	15,215	3.8%
12	Nashville–Davidson–Murfreesboro–Franklin, TN	13,191	2.2%
13	Miami–Fort Lauderdale–Pompano Beach, FL	10,078	1.0%
14	San Antonio–New Braunfels, TX	9,808	1.2%
15	Raleigh–Cary, NC	9,124	2.2%
16	Kansas City, MO–KS	8,674	1.3%
17	Columbus, OH	7,171	1.3%
18	St. Louis, MO–IL	6,847	0.7%
19	Cincinnati, OH–KY–IN	6,565	1.0%
20	Riverside–San Bernardino–Ontario, CA	6,512	0.6%
21	Birmingham–Hoover, AL	6,428	1.8%

#	Metro	Homes	Share of SF stock
22	Lakeland–Winter Haven, FL	6,255	2.4%
23	Seattle–Tacoma–Bellevue, WA	5,684	0.6%
24	Denver–Aurora–Lakewood, CO	5,626	0.8%
25	Chicago–Naperville–Elgin, IL–IN–WI	4,834	0.2%
26	Oklahoma City, OK	4,767	1.0%
27	Winston-Salem, NC	4,497	1.9%
28	Cape Coral–Fort Myers, FL	4,249	1.5%
29	Greenville–Anderson, SC	4,138	1.4%
30	Los Angeles–Long Beach–Anaheim, CA	3,843	0.2%

These thirty metros account for 433,020 homes — roughly 82% of the national total of about 530,000. The remaining 18% is spread across some 360 other metropolitan areas.

17.2.1 How to read this table

The percentage is the number that matters, not the rank. Dallas–Fort Worth is second by count and fifteenth by concentration. Memphis is eleventh by count and second by share. A metro can hold a great many institutionally owned homes and still be a market where you never encounter one, because the denominator is large. Chapter 9 works that through in full.

Percentages are published to one decimal place. Two figures are given to two decimals in the underlying analysis and appear that way in this book: Atlanta at **4.16%** and Jacksonville at **3.60%**. Precise figures for the other twenty-eight metros are not published.

The Northeast does not appear. No metropolitan area in Maryland, Pennsylvania, Massachusetts, Connecticut, New York, New Jersey or New England is in the top thirty. Chapter 10 is written for readers in those markets.

This is a floor, not a census. Chapter 7 lists four categories of

control the records cannot show — adviser relationships, general partner chains, 25% equity holders, and entities acting in concert. The true figures are higher than these by an amount nobody can currently quantify.

And these are stock figures, not flow. They describe homes owned as of early 2026. They do not describe purchasing, which collapsed during 2026, or selling, which rose. Chapter 12 covers the movement.

Source. Parcl Labs, *The Housing Bill's 350-Home Threshold: Who It Captures and What Comes Next* (Lewris and Ferguson, March 10, 2026). **Commercial research published by a data vendor**, cited as such throughout this book and not as government data. Counts reflect true-owner roll-up methodology, with subsidiaries attributed to controlling parents and government entities, home-builders and nonprofits removed. Retrieved September 2026.

Sources

Every chapter carries its own source note. This is the consolidated list, grouped by what kind of claim each source can support — because they are not interchangeable, and the difference is most of Part Two’s argument.

Primary — the statute itself

PL. 119-101, the 21st Century ROAD to Housing Act. Enrolled text at [BILLS-119hr6644enr](#), [govinfo](#). Became law July 11, 2026 without signature. Every statutory claim in this book — the 350-home threshold, the three prongs of investment control, the eleven excepted purchases, the definition of a single-family home, penalties, the January 7 2027 effective date, the fifteen-year sunset, §202’s eligible-landlord test, §1202’s funding language, and the provisions catalogued in Chapter 15 — comes from this text.

H.R. 5990 and the Senate’s ROAD to Housing Act of 2025 (§204), also at [govinfo](#). Used in Chapter 14 to establish that the \$30 million funding subsection existed in prior versions and was removed before enactment.

Executive Order 14376 (January 20, 2026), cited in Chapter 15 as a separate instrument, not part of this Act.

Government reports

GAO-26-108675 (March 24, 2026). Six metros, 2018–2024, at a **5,000-home** threshold. Source for pre-2018 institutional ownership shares and metro-level acquisition patterns.

GAO-24-106643 (May 22, 2024). A review of prior studies at

a **1,000-home** threshold. Source of the widely repeated “Atlanta 25%” figure, which is a share of single-family *rentals*.

Neither uses the statute’s 350-home threshold. Chapter 5 explains why that matters more than it appears to.

Commercial research

Parcl Labs, *The Housing Bill’s 350-Home Threshold: Who It Captures and What Comes Next* (March 10, 2026) — the ~140 entities, ~530,000 homes, 0.59% national share, the top-thirty metro distribution and the ZIP-level concentrations. Also their published documentation for the free tier, Housing Intelligence Reports, the four-bucket investor segmentation and the 1,000-property definition of Large Institutional Share.

CNBC Property Play, Diana Olick (July 21, 2026), reporting Parcl Labs data — institutional listing counts, asking values, net sales by the largest landlords, price-cut rates and the 589,000 / 3.9% figures. **Single-source, and its three figures do not reconcile internally**, as Chapter 6 sets out.

AllStreet Capital (July 6, 2026) — the decline in large-investor purchasing from roughly 250 to 100 homes a day. Single-source and not independently verified.

Realtor.com, John Burns Research and Consulting, Bank of America Global Research, Urban Institute and the American Enterprise Institute — cited in Chapters 5 and 6 for the competing thresholds and denominators that make up the definitions problem.

All of the above are commercial or research organisations publishing analysis of proprietary or licensed data. They are cited as vendor research, never as government data.

Legal and policy analysis

Greenberg Traurig (July 2026) — HUD notification requirements, renter outreach obligations, and the allocation of rulemaking to Treasury in consultation with HUD, FHFA and the SEC.

Holland & Knight (August 2026) — section-by-section analysis; independent confirmation of the §202 eligible-landlord test.

Morgan Lewis (July 2026), **KJK** (July 10, 2026), **Urban Institute** (June 30, 2026) — the absence of funding across the Act, and §202’s dependence on a future appropriation.

NCSHA and **Holland & Knight** — the Innovation Fund’s \$200 million annual authorisation being read as operative.

Bipartisan Policy Center implementation tracker — funding status by section, including “No funding authorized” against §202, and regulatory deadlines. **BPC Action** (circa September 1, 2026) — the FY2027 appropriations letter.

HousingWire (March 2026) — analyst commentary on the threshold and restructuring. *Note: this article also describes a seven-year disposal requirement that was stripped by House amendment on May 20, 2026. It predates the amendment, and Chapter 4 treats it as an example of how stale claims circulate.*

Advocacy

American Economic Liberties Project, *The New Rent Seekers* (April 2026), and associated county-level reporting. Cited in Chapter 6 as advocacy, attributed rather than relied upon. Home-repair advocacy pages promoting the stripped \$30 million are discussed in Chapter 14 — those are the error, not the source.

Carrying costs

Maurice Johnson, *The Landlord's Cost Map* (Dominion Publishing, 2026). Every state cost figure carried into this book — Florida insurance, the Connecticut mill rates, Georgia's 40% assessment ratio, Cleveland's yield, Franklin County's rate, Texas, Michigan's Principal Residence Exemption, Colorado's split rates, Maryland, Massachusetts and Washington's rent cap — is from that book, where each is sourced to the relevant statute, agency or case.

A note on dates

All figures are current as of **September 2026**. The statute is fixed; almost nothing else here is. Chapter 17 names which chapters will go stale first and what to check.

About the Author

Maurice Johnson arranges hard money and private lending. He does not lend his own funds; he places deals with third-party lending partners, and those partners pay him when a loan closes.

That is worth stating plainly, because it shapes this book. He sees the deals that fail, and they fail for the same handful of reasons over and over — a borrower who models taxes from the seller's bill, an exit that assumes a sixty-day sale in an eighty-day market, a compliance certificate nobody budgeted the calendar time for. It also means he has an interest in people borrowing money, and this book has been written to be worth reading by someone who never calls him.

He is the author of *The Landlord's Cost Map*, which works through the carrying costs that decide a rental deal across twelve states, and writes from East Texas.

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